

Mousiki User Guide v3.0.0 (Windows · Linux · macOS) – music player and radio

Mousiki is two programs in one: a terminal **music player** (chapters 1 to 10) and an **online radio** (chapter 11). Press **SHIFT** and **+** to switch between them (see [Two modes in one program](#)).

The music player chapters walk through **every entry of the in-app cheat sheet (?)** in the same order the cheat sheet lists them, and explain what each command does. Some settings that can only be changed in the `config.txt` are also discussed at the end of chapter 10. The radio chapter only describes what is new in the radio; everything both modes have in common (equalizer, oscilloscope, loudness normalization, sleep timer ...) is explained once in the player chapters. The key shown for each command is the **default binding**. Your own bindings may differ if you changed them in `config.txt` or under **Settings** → **Reference**; the cheat sheet always shows the keys you actually have.

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Before you start

Rebindable vs. fixed keys

- **Rebindable keys** have an action name like `HKeyPlay` in `config.txt` and appear under **Settings** → **Reference**. Change them in either place.
- **Fixed keys** are written as literal key names in the cheat sheet (for example `ESC`, `SHIFT+b`, `CTRL+SHIFT+s`, or the keys inside the playlist and meta editors). These cannot be rebound.

ALT on macOS (`Option`)

This guide writes the modifier as `ALT` (`ALT+L`, `ALT+←` / `ALT+→`). On a Mac that is the **Option** (`⌘`) key: a macOS build of Mousiki shows `OPTION+L` / `OPTION+LEFT/RIGHT` in the cheat sheet and `[Option+↔]` in the playlist editor's legend, everything else is identical. Two things to know:

- **Terminal setting:** Terminals on macOS only pass Option through as a modifier if you tell them to. In *Terminal.app* tick **Settings** → **Profiles** → **Keyboard** → **"Use Option as Meta key"**; in *iTerm2* set **Settings** → **Profiles** → **Keys** → **Left Option key** to **Esc+**. Without it, Option+L types a special character (e.g. ↵) that Mousiki never sees as a command. You can skip this setting: the lyrics timing overlay can also be opened (and closed) with **CTRL+L** on macOS and Linux, which needs no terminal setup. **OPTION+←** / **OPTION+→** (playlist tabs) work in *Terminal.app* and *iTerm2* without it, because they send the standard word-movement codes.
- **Option+←/→** (playlist editor tab switch) is sent as **ESC b** / **ESC f** by *Terminal.app* and *iTerm2* out of the box, and Mousiki understands both that and the xterm form, so it works without the setting above.

Uppercase letters

Several commands use **Shift + letter** (**T**, **N**, **M**, **P**, **H**, **X**) because the plain lowercase letter already does something else. Where this guide writes **SHIFT+t**, it means the uppercase **T** (the cheat sheet writes it the same way).

Two modes in one program

	Music player	Radio
What it plays	Your local files and YouTube streams	Internet radio stations
Settings file	<code>config.txt</code>	<code>radio_config.txt</code>
Guide	Chapters 1 to 10	Chapter 11

SHIFT and **+** (it types the ***** character) switches between the two, in both directions. The player is **paused and kept in memory** while the radio runs, so coming back is instant; the radio is **closed completely** when you leave it. The cheat sheet of both modes shows the switch key as its first line, adapted to your keyboard layout (detected automatically, `MOUSIKI_KEYBOARD=us|de|fr|...` overrides it). It is a fixed key. **SHIFT+m** stays the meta editor.

The main screen

The main screen has a **local/online/playlist list** on the left (titled **LOCAL AUDIO FILES**, **ONLINE RESULTS** or **SAVED PLAYLISTS**), a **Queue** panel, a metadata panel with lyrics or a visualizer, and a search box. Only one of the list or the queue has **focus** at a time. Focus decides where the arrow keys work (see **TAB** below).

Window size. The list and queue panes use every row the terminal has left under the metadata panel, progress bar and search box, so a maximised window is filled down to its last line. Resize at any time, also while a menu is open: Settings, Console, the playlist and meta editors and the listening history take the same height as the main screen, and the cheat sheet (?) uses the full terminal height. The playlist and meta editors keep a few rows at the bottom for their legend and status messages. The cheat sheet and the listening history keep no empty rows. The history shows a status message in a row of its own only while there is one.

Play mode letter

The small box next to the search bar shows the current play mode as a letter: **L** list, **R** repeat, **S** shuffle, **O** stop, **Q** queue then stop.

1. System (main UI)

Key	Action	What it does
SHIFT+ +	Switch to the radio	Switches to the radio mode (and back from there). The player is paused and waits in the background. See Two modes in one program and Radio mode . Fixed key.
s	Open Settings	Opens the Settings panel (see Settings for every tab). Inside Settings, s again saves to config.txt and closes . ESC or q discards the changes made on the screen and closes.
SHIFT+r	Rescan library	Rescans the music folders, e.g. after files were copied or downloaded in the meantime or after coming back from the radio. Also works in the meta editor while the library pane or the fetch list has the focus. Fixed key.
t	Console / logs	Opens a read-only log view showing what the app has been doing (sort changes, filter changes, queue messages, load timings and so on). Close it with ESC , t or T .
?	Cheat sheet	Opens the command list. Use ↑/↓ to scroll (the list is longer than most terminal windows). Close with ? or ESC .
q	Quit	Quits the application from the main screen.
ESC	Close / back	Closes whatever is open (an overlay, a menu, a prompt; in Settings it discards the changes). On the main screen it returns to the <i>home view</i> : the full local library, with no search query and no folder filter, scrolled to the top. It does not change the sort mode.
ENTER	Confirm / select	Confirms the highlighted choice or starts the highlighted item. What it does depends on where you are (play a track, queue a playlist, commit a search and so on).
ARROW KEYS	Navigate	Move up and down through lists, left and right to seek or move a text caret. What they do depends on the current screen.
Y / N	Confirm or cancel a prompt	Answers Yes/No prompts such as "Want to clear queue?" or "Fetching metadata via AcoustID ... Continue?".

Tips

- Almost every overlay closes with **ESC**.
- Prompts swallow other keys while they are open, so nothing underneath can be triggered by accident. **The cheat sheet (?)** is the screen this guide follows. The footer shows how far you have scrolled (**1/87**).

```

- CHEATSHEET -
SYSTEM (MAIN UI)
s      Open Settings panel, hit again to save and quit
t      Console / logs
?      This cheatsheet
q      Quit
ESC    Close setting / overlay / menu
ENTER  Confirm / select
ARROW KEYS  Navigate (context-dependent)
Y / N  Confirm or cancel a prompt

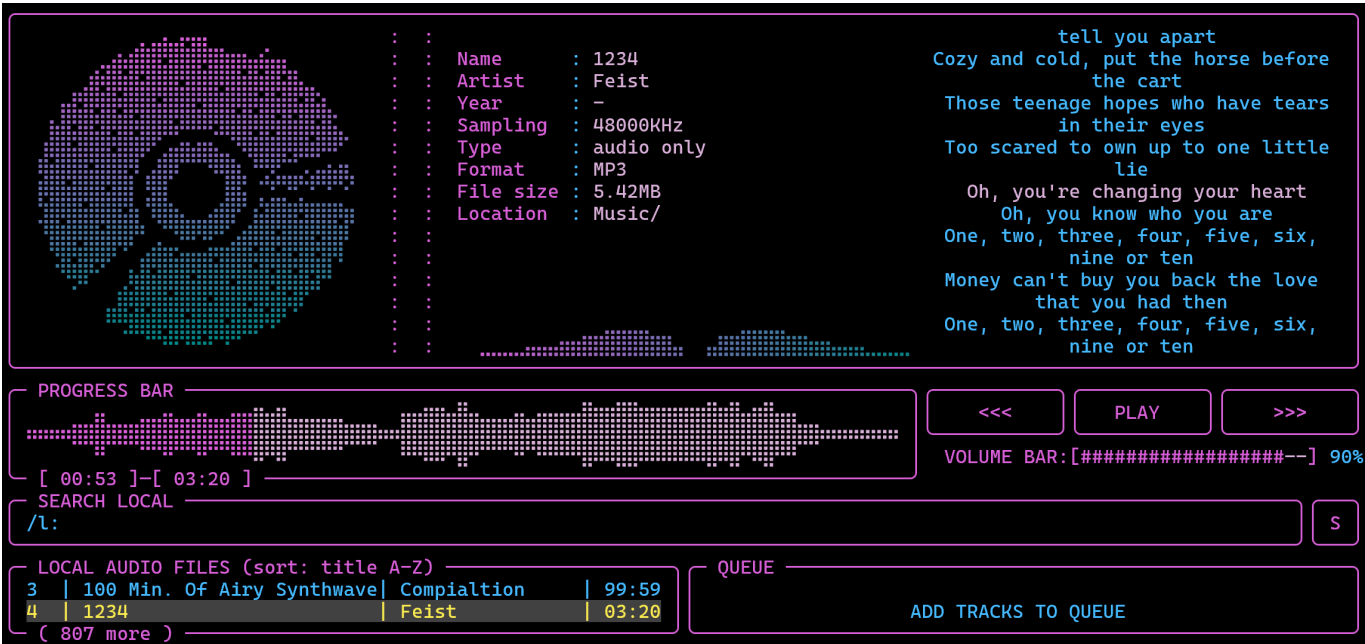
PLAYBACK (MAIN UI)
ENTER  Play the selected track
p      Play / pause
n      Play next in list/queue
b      Play previous in list
#      Shuffle to a random next track
m      Cycle play mode (list/repeat/shuffle/repeat queue/stop)
ARROW_KEY_RIGHT  Seek forward 5s
ARROW_KEY_LEFT   Seek backward 5s
1          Volume up
2          Volume down
x          Mute (without pausing)
v          Toggle loudness normalization
[? / ESC] close  [↑↓] scroll 1/87

```

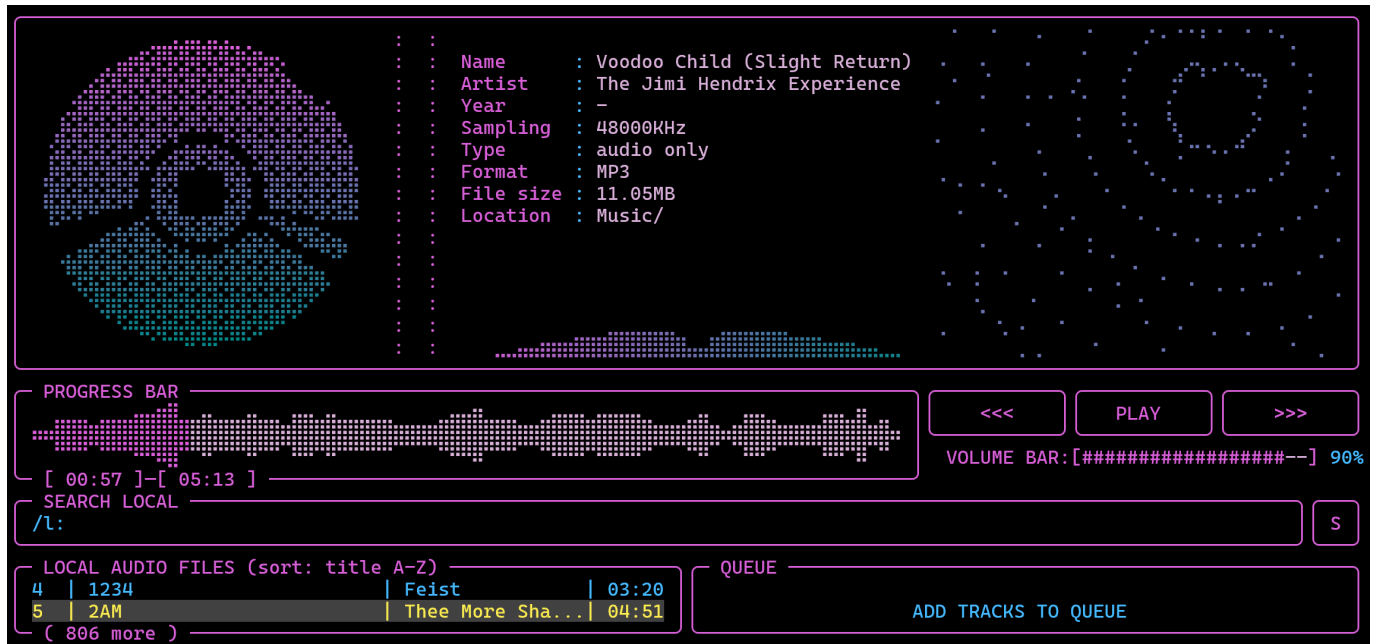
The cheat sheet, opened with ?. Scroll with ↑/↓; ? or ESC closes it.

2. Playback (main UI)

The main screen while a track plays: the disk, the metadata panel, the visualizer and the lyrics area at the top, then the progress bar with its waveform, the volume bar, the search box, and the local file list and queue at the bottom. The box on the right of the search bar shows the play mode letter (here S for shuffle).



Main screen with the lyrics engine on: the lyrics fill the right-hand area.



Main screen with no lyrics shown: the audio-reactive **lyric ball** (Settings → ON/OFF → Lyric Ball) fills the area instead.

Key	Action	What it does
ENTER	Play the selected track	Starts the highlighted track. Pressing it again on the same track reloads it. On a playlist row it does not play. It queues every track in that playlist instead.
p	Play / pause	Pauses or resumes the current track.
n	Next	Plays the next track. If the queue has items, the next queue item plays. Otherwise the next track in the list plays (relative to what is <i>playing</i> , not where your cursor is). A manual skip always skips, even in repeat or stop mode.
b	Previous	Plays the previous track in the list. There is no queue equivalent, because a queue that has been consumed has no meaningful "previous".
#	Shuffle next	A one-off jump to a random track from the current list . It ignores the queue on purpose and is independent of the shuffle play mode.
m	Cycle play mode	Steps through the five play modes (see below).
→	Seek forward	Jumps forward 5 seconds .
←	Seek backward	Jumps back 5 seconds .
1	Volume up	Raises the in-app volume in steps of 5 (up to 100).
2	Volume down	Lowest the in-app volume in steps of 5 (down to 0).
x	Mute	Sets the volume to 0 without pausing. Pressing it again restores the previous volume.
v	Toggle loudness normalization	Turns loudness normalization on or off, so you can compare a track with and without it. When turned on, the status line shows the track's

Key	Action	What it does
		measured loudness and the correction applied. The target and maximum boost are set with the SHIFT+v overlay (see <i>Loudness normalization overlay</i> below) or in config.txt .
E (Shift+E)	Equalizer	Opens the 10-band equalizer overlay with presets. The sound changes live while you adjust it. See <i>Equalizer overlay</i> below.

Equalizer overlay (**SHIFT+e**)

Opens a window in the middle of the screen with a **10-band graphic equalizer**. Each band is a vertical slider from **-12 dB** to **+12 dB**, with the center line at 0 dB. The bands sit at **31, 62, 125, 250, 500 Hz, 1, 2, 4, 8 and 16 kHz**. The selected band is highlighted, and its gain and name are shown underneath. The top line of the window shows the current **preset**, whether the **EQ is ON or OFF**, and the **preamp** (see below). The key legend at the bottom of the window is drawn in the same color as the window's border.

The equalizer works on everything the player plays and changes the sound **while the music plays**, so you can adjust it by ear. Playback keeps running while the overlay is open, but its keys are the only ones that react until you close it. The overlay opens on every main screen.

Key	Action
← / →	Select the previous / next band (wraps around)
↑ / ↓	Raise / lower the selected band by 1 dB
, or <	Previous preset
. or > or TAB	Next preset (the built-in presets first, then your custom presets)
0	Set the selected band to 0 dB
SPACE	Switch the equalizer on / off. The gains stay as they are.
R	Reset all bands to Flat . The on / off state is not changed.
S	Save the current curve as a custom preset . A <i>Save as:</i> prompt opens under the sliders (see <i>Custom presets</i> below).
DEL or X	Delete the selected custom preset. Press it twice to confirm.
ESC or SHIFT+e	Close the overlay. The settings are saved to config.txt when it closes.

Switching on. Moving a band or choosing a preset also turns the equalizer on, so what you change is always what you hear. Use **SPACE** to compare against the original sound.

Presets. The preset keys cycle through the list below in this order, and then through your own custom presets (see below), in the order you saved them. If the gains do not match any preset exactly (for example after you moved a band), the top line shows **Custom**. Stepping to the next or previous preset then continues from the last preset you used.

Preset	Gains in dB, 31 Hz → 16 kHz
Flat	0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0
Bass Boost	+6, +5, +4, +2, +1, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0
Treble Boost	0, 0, 0, 0, 0, +1, +2, +4, +5, +6
Vocal	-2, -3, -3, +1, +3, +4, +3, +2, 0, -1
Rock	+4, +3, +2, -1, -2, -1, +1, +3, +4, +4
Pop	-1, +1, +3, +4, +3, 0, -1, -1, -1, -1
Jazz	+3, +2, +1, +2, -2, -2, 0, +1, +2, +3
Classical	+4, +3, +3, +2, -1, -1, 0, +2, +3, +3
Electronic	+5, +4, +1, 0, -2, +2, +1, +1, +4, +5
Hip-Hop	+5, +4, +2, +3, -1, -1, +2, 0, +2, +3
Acoustic	+4, +4, +3, +1, +2, +2, +3, +3, +3, +2
Loudness	+6, +4, +1, 0, -1, -1, 0, +1, +4, +5

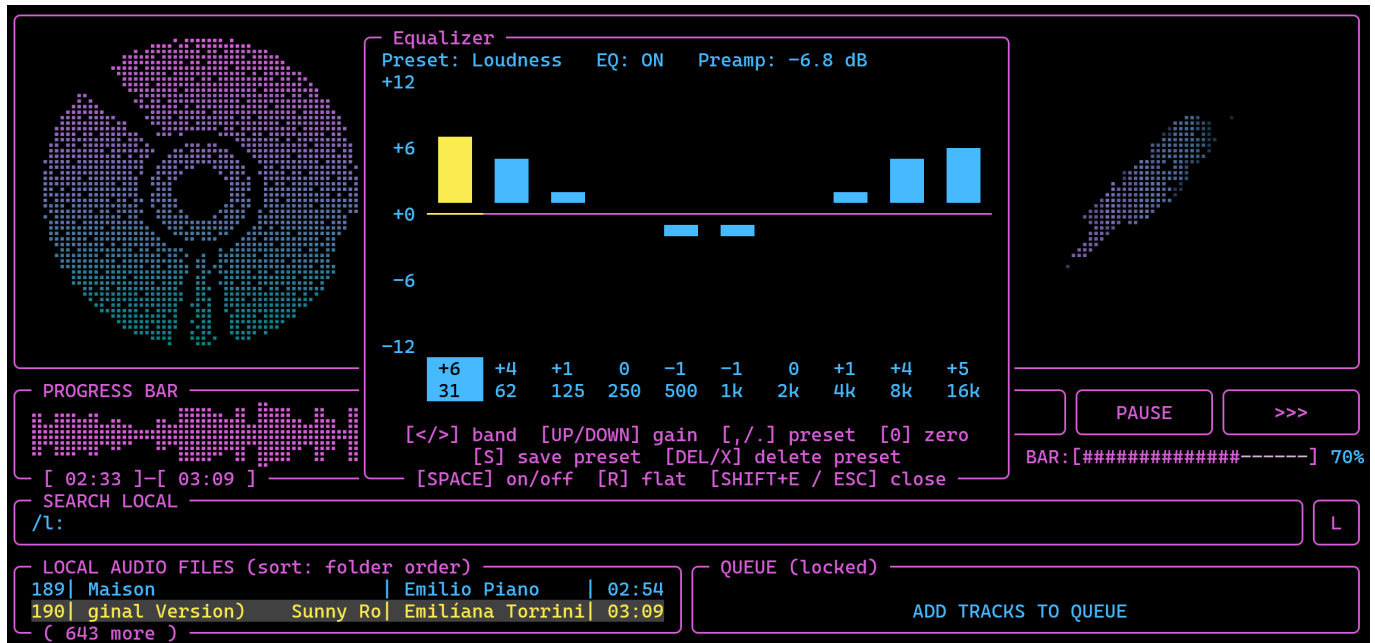
Custom presets. Shape the sliders the way you like, then press **S** to keep the curve as a preset of your own.

- A **Save as:** prompt replaces the line under the sliders and the legend changes to the prompt's keys. Type a name (up to **16 characters**) and press **ENTER** to save it, or **ESC** to cancel. Only the prompt closes on **ESC**; the equalizer stays open. The usual text keys work in the prompt: **← / →**, **HOME / END**, **SHIFT+← / SHIFT+→** to mark, and **CTRL+C / CTRL+X / CTRL+V**.
- The new preset is added **after the built-in presets** and appears on the top line under its name whenever the sliders match it. It is written to **config.txt** **immediately**, not only when the overlay closes.
- If you moved a band away from one of your custom presets, the prompt starts with that preset's name, so **ENTER** alone **updates** it. A name that already belongs to a custom preset (capital letters don't matter) **replaces** that preset.
- The names of the built-in presets and the word *Custom* cannot be used. The characters **=**, **{** and **}** are replaced by **-**, because the configuration file uses them. You can keep up to **24** custom presets.
- To **delete** one, select it with **,** / **.** so that the top line shows its name, press **DEL** (or **X**), and press it again within the overlay to confirm. Any other key cancels the deletion. The built-in presets cannot be deleted. The sliders keep their current values after a deletion and show **Custom**.
- Short messages such as *Saved "My Mix"*, *Updated "My Mix"* or *Deleted "My Mix"* appear on the line under the sliders and disappear with the next key press.

Preamp. Boosting bands makes the whole signal louder and can push it into distortion. The player therefore lowers the level automatically by the height of the loudest point of your curve. The **Preamp** value on the top line shows this (for example **-7.1 dB** for Bass Boost). The sound will be slightly quieter with a strong boost than without the equalizer, and that is intended. Raise the volume if you need it louder. The equalizer is bypassed completely when it is off or all bands are 0 dB.

Good to know.

- On a track with a low sample rate (22.05 kHz, for example) the top band is too close to the limit of the signal and is skipped.
- **Loudness normalization** (**v**) measures the track *before* the equalizer. With a strong boost or cut a track can therefore end up a little louder or quieter than the normalization target.
- The window is 21 rows high (15 on a terminal with fewer than 24 rows, see the next point), so it still fits on a 24-row terminal.
- On a terminal with fewer than 24 rows the sliders are drawn in steps of 4 dB instead of 2 dB, so the window fits. The gains themselves still change in steps of 1 dB.



In radio mode the same overlay opens on the same key (**SHIFT+e**) with the same keys and presets. The radio keeps its own curve and its own custom presets in `radio_config.txt`, independent of the player's (see 11.4).

The five play modes (**m**)

Each press moves to the next mode in this order: **list** → **repeat** → **shuffle** → **stop** → **queue then stop** → **list**

...

Mode	Letter	Behavior when a track finishes
List	L	Plays the next track in the list (the queue takes priority when it has items).
Repeat	R	Replays the same track again.
Shuffle	S	Plays a random track. If the queue has more than one item, a random queue item is chosen.
Stop	O	Plays the track and then stops, with no automatic advance. The "no track loaded" screen with the cassette is shown.
Queue then stop	Q	Plays the queue once , then stops. It never falls through to the library: when the queue is used up, playback ends (like Stop mode), also when the queue was empty to begin with and a library track finishes. With the queue locked (default) each item goes to the back as it is played and the pass ends after the last unplayed item, so the queue is back in its original order afterwards. Tracks you add during the pass (a , e , bulk add)

Mode	Letter	Behavior when a track finishes
		still play before it ends. Unlocked, played items leave the queue and it stops when it is empty. n always skips on, also after the pass is over (it starts a new one).

3. Navigation & view (main UI)

Key	Action	What it does
↑	Explore list up	Moves the highlight up in the focused panel (list or queue).
↓	Explore list down	Moves the highlight down in the focused panel.
TAB	Switch between panels	Moves focus between the list and the queue . This decides which panel the up/down arrows, d (remove), 4/5 (move) and a (add / bulk add) act on.
f	Filter by folder	Narrows the local list to the folder of the highlighted track . It also switches the sort back to <i>folder order</i> . The pane title then shows sort: folder order, folder: <name> [c] clear . The filter stacks on top of an active search.
c	Clear filter	Removes the folder filter. It leaves the sort mode alone.
T (Shift+T)	Cycle local list sort mode	Cycles the sort of the local list through three modes: folder order → title A-Z → artist A-Z . The current mode is shown in the pane title (see below).
k	Refresh UI	Forces a full redraw. Use it when a terminal resize or a switch of terminal session left the screen torn or stale.
w	Toggle waveform style	Switches the waveform between raw and smooth .
+	Cycle lyrics area	Cycles the lyrics area through three views: lyrics → sphere → oscilloscope → lyrics The two visuals are the lyrics engine's <i>off</i> states: no lyrics are fetched from the network while one of them is shown, and the choice is stored in the Lyric Viz setting. Coming back to the lyrics fetches them for the current track right away.
N (Shift+N)	Toggle metadata-only track list	Switches every list row between filename and metadata title (the embedded title tag). Files with no title tag, or whose tags have not been read yet, keep showing their filename. This also switches what "title A-Z" sorts by (see below). Also available in Settings → ON/OFF .
l	Retry lyrics	Opens a small form to fetch lyrics again with a manual title and artist . Use it when the automatic match was wrong.
ALT+l	Adjust lyrics	Opens a small overlay menu for live adjustment of the lyrics timing.
O (Shift+O)	Oscilloscope tuning	Opens a small overlay to change the oscilloscope's afterglow, line thickness and tail live . See <i>The oscilloscope</i> below.

Key	Action	What it does
V (Shift+V)	Normalization tuning	Opens a small overlay to switch loudness normalization on or off and to change its target level and maximum boost live . See <i>Loudness normalization overlay</i> below.
Z (Shift+Z)	Sleep timer	Opens a small overlay to pause playback after 15, 30, 60, 90 or 120 minutes, or to stop after the current song. See <i>Sleep timer overlay</i> below.

How the sort mode and **SHIFT+n** work together

The sort mode in the pane title always tells you what is being sorted on:

Sort mode	Pane title shows	Sorted by
Folder order	sort: folder order	The order the files were found on disk
Title A-Z, SHIFT+n off	sort: file name A-Z	The file name
Title A-Z, SHIFT+n on	sort: title A-Z	The embedded title tag (falling back to the file name where there is none)
Artist A-Z	sort: artist A-Z	The artist tag (falling back to the artist guessed from the parent folder)

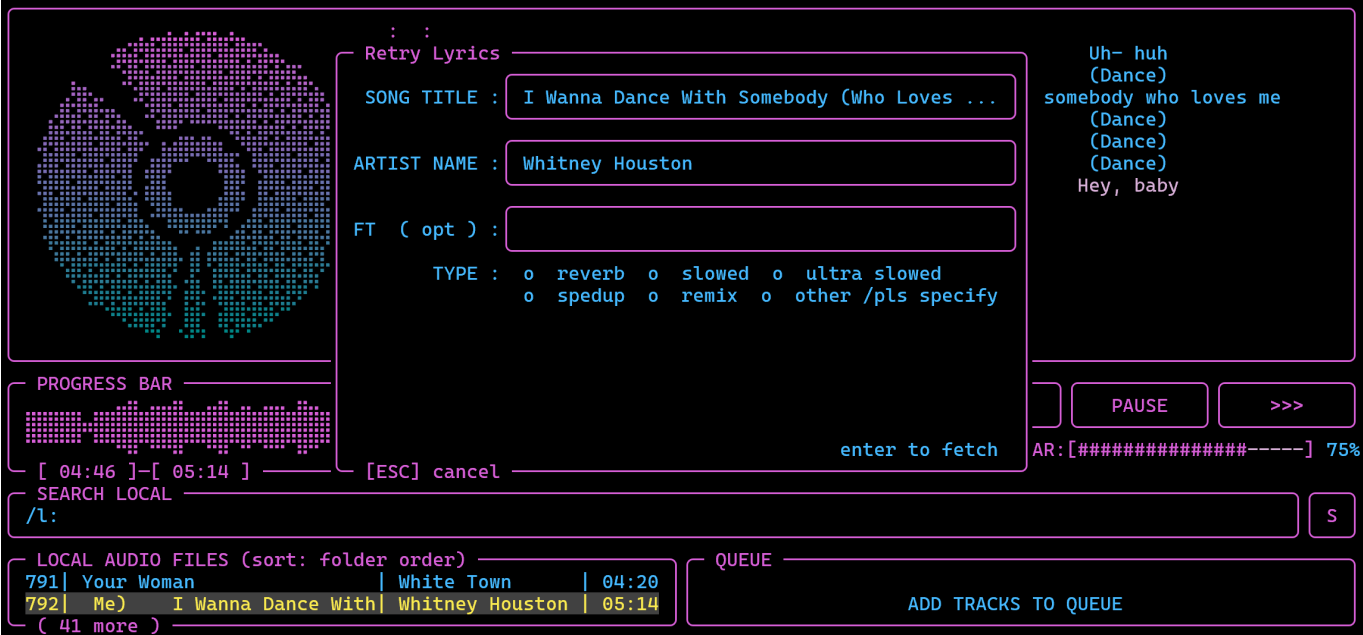
Toggling **SHIFT+n** re-sorts the list immediately and keeps your cursor on the same track. In **metadata-only** mode the order can shift slightly right after startup, while the background scan is still reading tags.

A **search** always ranks by match quality, so while a query is active the sort mode is not used. It applies again once the query is cleared.

How the lyrics form (**l**) works

Key in the form	Function
TAB / ↓	Next field
↑	Previous field
SPACE	Tick or untick a checkbox (slowed, ultra-slowed, sped up, reverb, remix, other). Slowed, ultra-slowed and sped up are mutually exclusive.
Typing	Fills the text fields
ENTER	Fetch lyrics with these settings (works from any field)
ESC	Cancel

l only works while the lyrics engine is on (+).

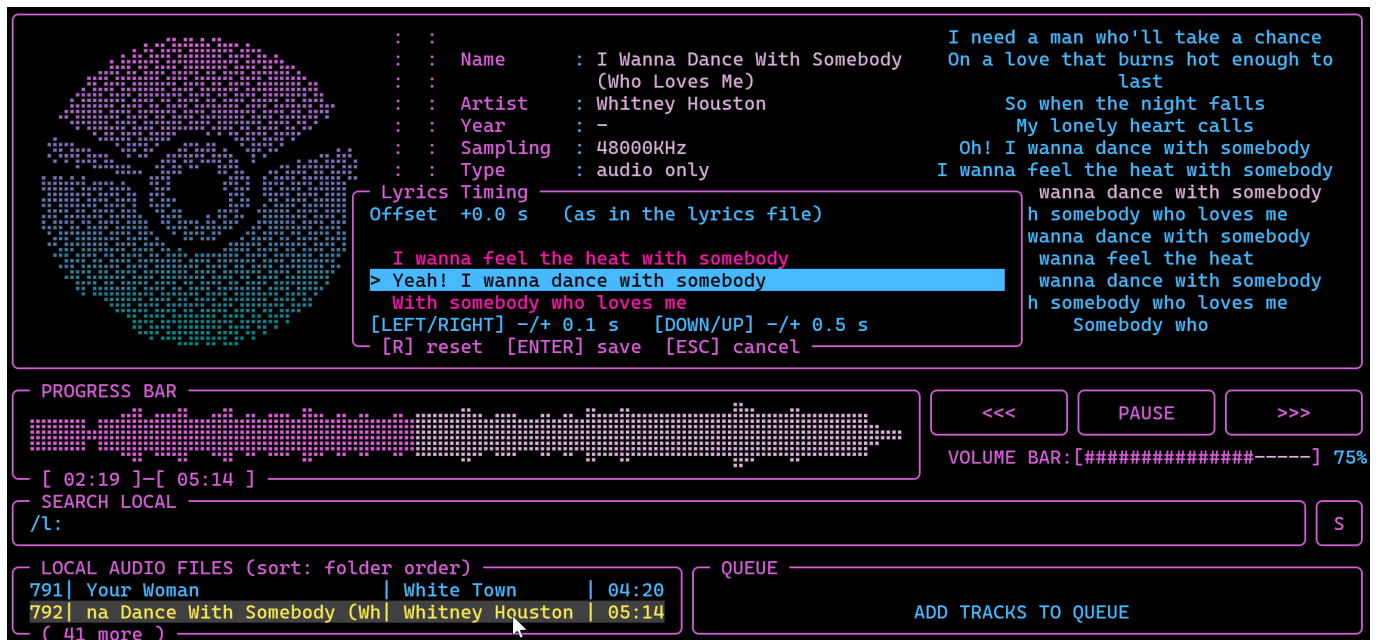


Lyrics timing overlay (ALT+L)

For tracks whose synced lyrics run ahead of or behind the music. The overlay shifts **all** lines (and, for word-synced lyrics, all words) of the playing track by the same amount. The change is visible **live** while the music plays, in the lyrics area and in the three lines shown in the overlay itself (previous, current and next line, with the current one highlighted). **ALT+L** opens only while synced lyrics are loaded for the track; otherwise the status line says so.

Key	What it does
→ / ←	Lyrics later / earlier by 0.1 s
↑ / ↓	Lyrics later / earlier by 0.5 s
R	Back to 0 (the timing as it is in the lyrics file)
ENTER or S	Save the offset into the track's lyrics file and close
ESC or ALT+1	Cancel: the offset from before the overlay was opened comes back

- A **positive** offset (+0.3 s) means the lyrics appear later than their timestamps say, so use it when the lyrics are **too early**. A negative offset makes them appear earlier. The range is ±30 s.
- Saving writes a standard [offset:...] tag at the top of the track's .lrc file (in the lyrics folder next to the track, in milliseconds, with the usual LRC sign convention: positive = earlier). The timestamps themselves are not changed. The offset is read back whenever the lyrics are loaded from that file, and other players that know the tag use it too. Saving 0 removes the tag.
- The offset belongs to **one track's lyrics file**. Fetching the lyrics again with 1 (retry) replaces the file and resets the offset. If there is no lyrics file for the track, the offset still applies until the track changes, but saving reports that it could not be saved.
- Playback keeps running while the overlay is open; only its keys react.



The oscilloscope (lyric visual)

When there are no lyrics to show (lyrics engine off, nothing found, or the fetch is still running) the lyrics area is filled by a **lyric visual**. With Settings → ON/OFF → **Lyric Viz** set to **osci** (or after pressing **+** to the oscilloscope view) that visual is an **XY oscilloscope** instead of the sphere.

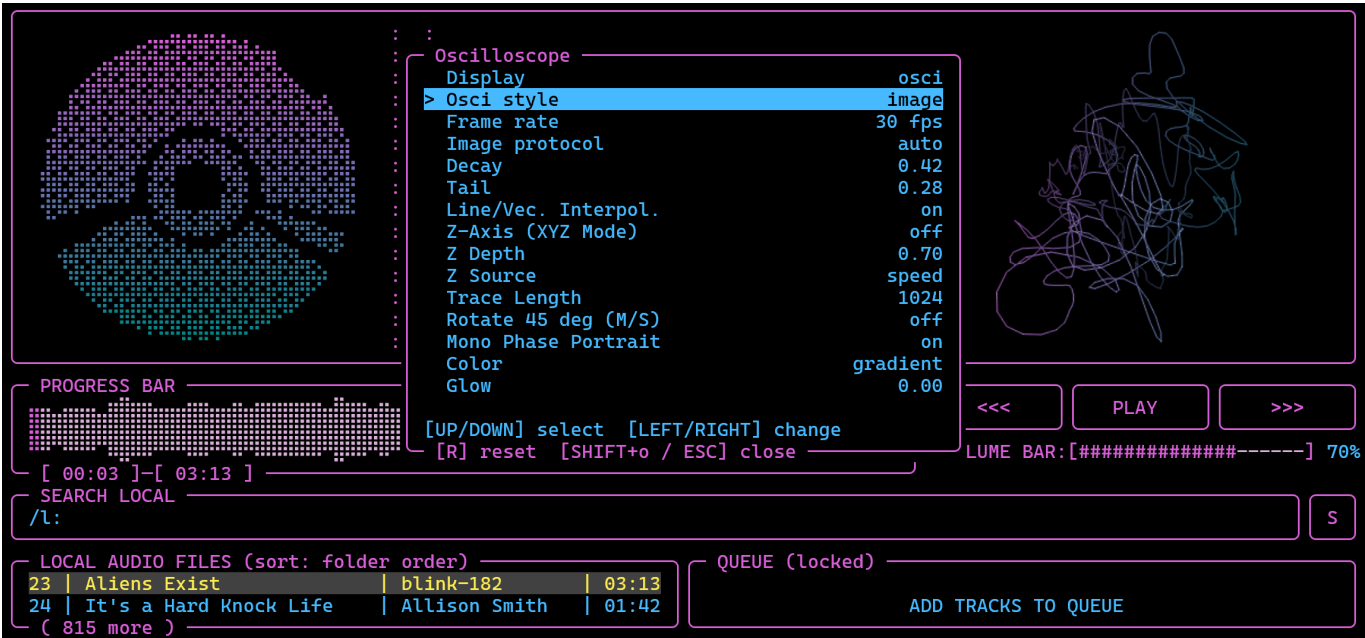
How it draws. Like a real scope in X-Y mode, the **left channel moves the beam horizontally and the right channel moves it vertically**. A track with a wide stereo image fills the area with a cloud, a pure tone with a phase shift between the channels draws an ellipse, and out-of-phase material leans the other way. The picture is drawn into the largest centred square of the lyrics area, so circles stay circles. A quiet track is boosted automatically, so it still fills the area.

Mono tracks. In a true XY scope a mono signal (left = right) can only draw a diagonal line. When a track is (nearly) mono, the scope therefore fades over to a *phase portrait* of the signal instead (the signal against its own rate of change), which draws loops and circles whose shape follows the sound. The switch is smooth, so a track hovering near the limit does not flicker.

Look. The trace is drawn with smooth, anti-aliased lines. Like the phosphor of an old oscilloscope it leaves a short **afterglow** that fades out, and the newest part of the trace is brighter than the oldest. The colour is the **VIZ** gradient (Settings → Colors → VIZ) running left to right, dimmed where the beam is weaker, so the fading trail also fades in colour.

Oscilloscope tuning overlay (**SHIFT+o**)

Opens a window in the middle of the screen where the look of the oscilloscope (and the display choice itself) can be changed **while the music plays**. It sits clear of the lyrics area, so you can watch the scope while you adjust it. The same overlay exists in the radio (on the same key).



Key	Action
↑ / ↓	Select a row (wraps around)
← / →	Decrease / increase the selected value, or step through its choices
R	Reset the rows of the style in use to their defaults
ESC or SHIFT+o	Close the overlay. The values are saved to config.txt when it closes.

Playback keeps running while the overlay is open, but its keys are the only ones that react until you close it. The overlay opens on every main screen. The rows are:

Row	Choices / range	What it does
Display	sphere / osci	What fills the lyrics area when there are no lyrics (same as Settings → ON/OFF → Lyric Viz). The rows below only affect the oscilloscope.
Osci style	braille / image	braille : the scope is drawn with Braille characters. image : a real pixel picture with glow, drawn by the terminal itself (see <i>Image style</i> below).
Frame rate	30 / 45 / 60 / 90 fps	How often the scope is redrawn.
Image protocol	auto / kitty / sixel / off	Image style only: which terminal graphics protocol is used.
Decay	0.00 – 0.99	The afterglow . Each frame the picture is dimmed by this factor, so higher values leave longer trails. 0.00 shows only the current trace. Values near 0.99 smear for a long time.
Dot threshold	0.01 – 1.00	Braille style only. How bright a point must be before it is drawn. Lower values give a thicker, softer line with a long fade. Higher values give a thin, sharp core, but fast parts of the trace can break into gaps.

Row	Choices / range	What it does
Tail	0.00 – 1.00	The brightness of the oldest part of the trace compared with the newest (1.00). Low values give a comet with a bright head and a fading tail, 1.00 makes the trace uniformly bright.
Glow	0.00 – 1.00 (step 0.05)	Image style only: how strongly the line glows.
Line/Vec. Interpol.	on / off	Connects the sample points with smooth lines.
Z-Axis (XYZ Mode)	on / off	Lets the beam brightness follow a third signal, like a real XYZ scope.
Z Depth	0.00 – 1.00 (step 0.05)	How strongly the Z signal dims the beam.
Z Source	speed / level	speed : the faster the beam moves, the dimmer it gets (like a CRT). level : the further from the centre, the brighter.
Trace Length	128 – 1024 samples (step 128)	How much of the signal is drawn at once.
Rotate 45 deg (M/S)	on / off	Rotates the picture by 45°, so mid/side (mono/stereo difference) lies on the axes.
Mono Phase Portrait	on / off	Fades a (nearly) mono signal over to a <i>phase portrait</i> (see <i>The oscilloscope</i>). Off draws the plain diagonal line.
Color	gradient, settings, temperature, aurora, magma, ice, neon, spectrum	gradient uses the VIZ colours of Settings → COLORS . The others are palettes that follow the beam speed.

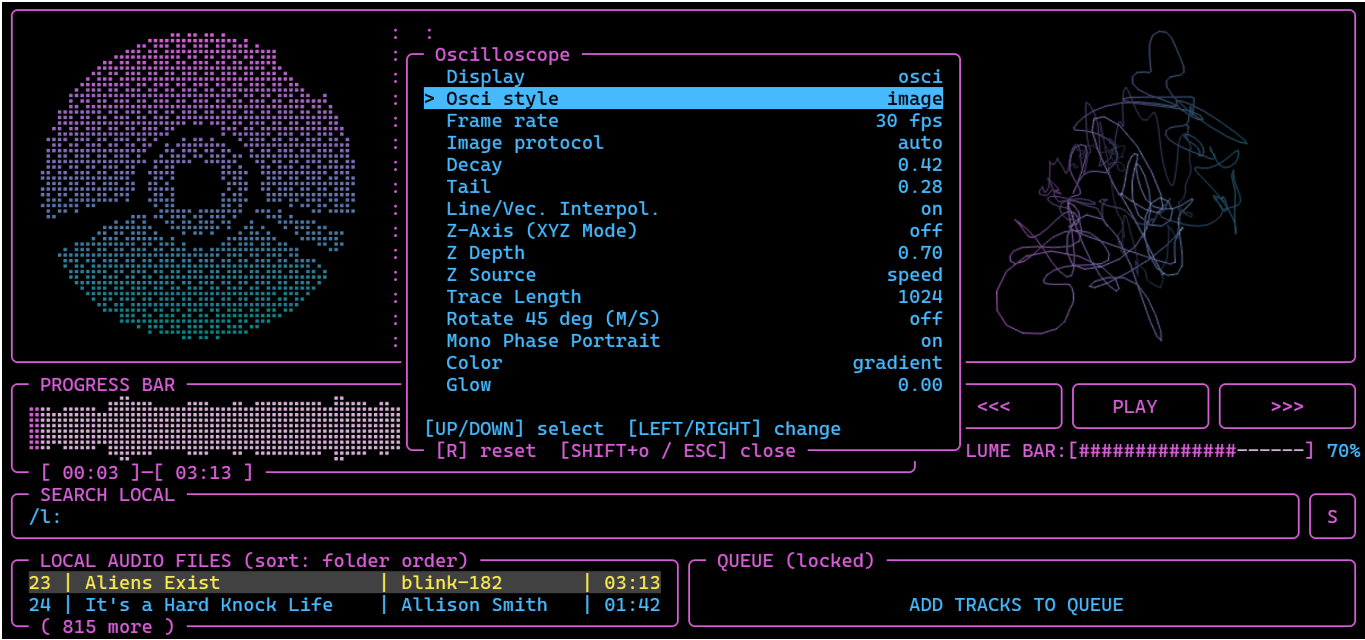
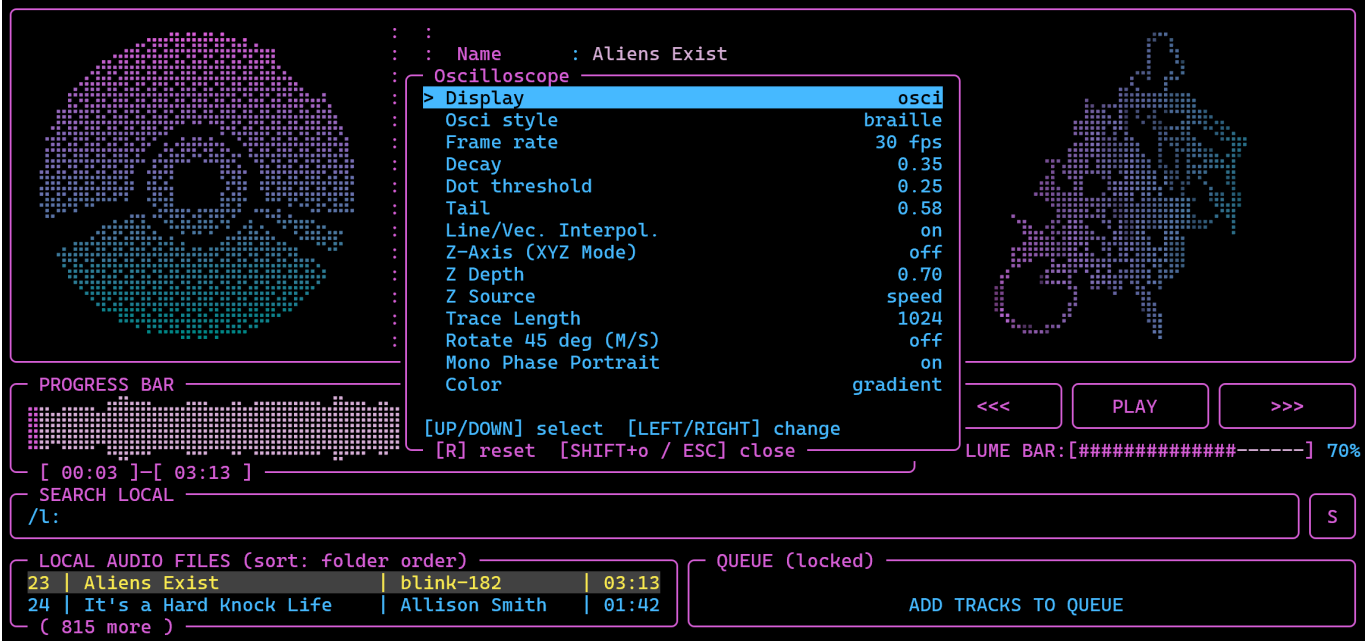
Each style keeps its own values. The braille and the image style have separate sets of Decay, Tail, Glow and the other numbers, so switching the style does not lose your tuning; **R** resets only the style in use. Decay, threshold and tail move in steps of 0.01 (tail 0.02).

Two starting points for the braille style: for a crisp, "real oscilloscope" look try Decay **0.65**, Dot threshold **0.35**, Tail **0.60**. For a glowing, dreamy look try **0.90**, **0.20**, **0.25**.

Image style. The terminal draws the picture itself, via the **Kitty graphics protocol** (Kitty, WezTerm, Ghostty, Konsole ...) or **Sixel** (Windows Terminal 1.22+, foot, xterm ...). Without either, the braille scope stays.

MOUSIKI_GFX=kitty|sixel|off forces a protocol and **MOUSIKI_CELLPX=10x20** sets the cell size (otherwise it is asked from the terminal). Pictures per second are limited to 60 with Kitty and 15 with Sixel. Small overlays that reach into the scope area hide the covered part of the picture, full-screen menus remove it.

In radio mode the overlay is the same; the radio has its own copy of the scope and its own values in **radio_config.txt**, and the environment variables are called **MOUSIKI_RADIO_GFX** and **MOUSIKI_RADIO_CELLPX** (see 11.4).



Loudness normalization overlay (SHIFT+v)

Opens a small window in the middle of the screen where loudness normalization can be switched on and off and tuned **while the music plays**. What you change is what you hear: the level glides to the new value within about a second, so there is no click. (The plain **v** key still toggles normalization on and off without opening anything.)

Key	Action
↑ / ↓	Select a row (wraps around)
← / →	On the Normalize row: switch off / on. On the other two rows: decrease / increase the value by 1.
SPACE or v	Switch normalization on / off from any row
R	Reset Target level and Max boost to their defaults. The on / off state is not changed.

Key	Action
ESC or SHIFT+v	Close the overlay. The values are saved to config.txt when it closes.

Playback keeps running while the overlay is open, but its keys are the only ones that react until you close it. The overlay opens on every main screen.

Row	Range	Step	Default	What it does
Normalize	off / on		on	Loudness normalization on or off. Same switch as the v key and Settings → ON/OFF → Normalize Volume .
Target level	-40 – 0 LUFS	1	-16	The loudness every track is measured against and played at. -16 leaves more headroom, -14 matches YouTube and Spotify. A lower number is quieter overall.
Max boost	0 – 24 dB	1	9	The most a quiet track may be raised. Loud or heavily compressed tracks are lowered regardless.

Live line. Below the three rows a grey line shows what is happening with the track that is playing right now: its measured loudness and the gain that is applied to it (+ = raised, - = lowered). If a quiet track would need more than **Max boost**, the applied gain stops at that limit, so this line is the quickest way to see whether the boost limit is holding a track back. For the first seconds of a track it shows *measuring loudness* until enough audio has been analysed.



Name : Ievan Polkka

Artist : Loituma

Year : -

Sampling : 48000KHz

Type : audio only

Format : MP3

Loudness normalization

> Normalize on

Target level -14 LUFS

Max boost 9 dB

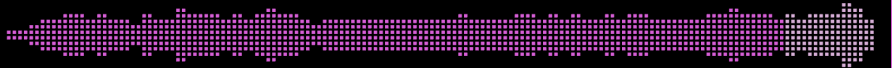
Track -14.0 LUFS applied gain +0.0 dB

[UP/DOWN] select [LEFT/RIGHT] change

[SPACE] on/off [R] reset [SHIFT+v / ESC] close

En ruppee sun terveyttä takkoomaa.
Terveenä pääset ku korjoot luusi
Ja määät siitä murjuus makkoomaa.
Ei tätä poikoo hellyys haittaa
Ko akkoja huhkii laista laitaan.
Salivili hipput tupput täppyt
äppyt tipput hilijalleen.
minä sanon jotta purra pittää
Ei mua niin voan nielasta.
at männä ite vaikka lännestä
ittään
Vaan minä en luovu Ievasta
illä ei tätä poikoo kainous
haittaa

PROGRESS BAR



[02:21]-[02:37]

SEARCH LOCAL

/l:

S

LOCAL AUDIO FILES (sort: folder order)

1 | Intro Theme | Silent Hill 0... | 02:51

2 | 100 Min. Of Airy Synthwave | Compialtion | 99:59

(831 more)

QUEUE

ADD TRACKS TO QUEUE

VOLUME BAR:[#####-----] 75%

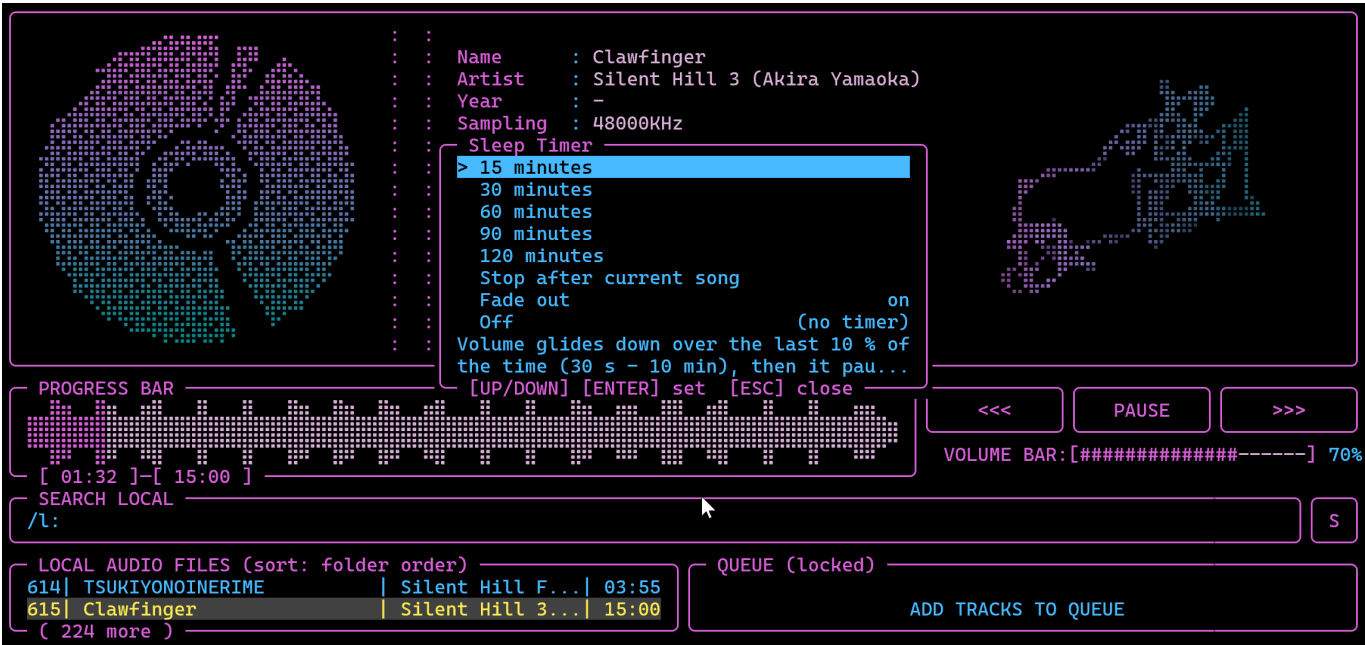
In radio mode the overlay and its range are the same. A live stream has no end, so the loudness is measured **since you tuned in** (see 11.4).

Sleep timer overlay (SHIFT+z)

A small overlay for falling asleep to music. Playback keeps running while it is open.

Key	What it does
↑ / ↓	Pick an entry: 15 / 30 / 60 / 90 / 120 minutes , Stop after current song , Fade out or Off .
ENTER	Set the picked entry and close the overlay. Picking the running minute entry again restarts its countdown. On the Fade out row it switches the fade on or off instead, and the overlay stays open.
ESC or SHIFT+z	Close the overlay without changing anything.

- While a timer is armed the remaining time (or **after song**) is shown in the title of the search bar, e.g. **SEARCH LOCAL [SLEEP 24:10]**.
- When a minute timer runs out, playback is **paused**, not stopped: the position is kept and **p** resumes it.
- **Fade out** (on by default, **SleepFade** in **config.txt**): over the last 10 % of the time (at least 30 seconds, at most 10 minutes) the volume glides down, so the music fades away instead of stopping abruptly. It multiplies your volume setting and is undone when the timer is cancelled.
- **Stop after current song** ends playback when the song that is playing ends, even if the queue still has tracks or the play mode is Repeat. It needs a playing song to attach to.
- The two kinds of timer exclude each other: setting one replaces the other. The timer is **not saved** and is gone after a restart.
- **Stop play mode**: the sleep timer never changes the play mode (**m**). *Stop after current song* is a one-shot on top of it, so with the Stop mode already on it is simply redundant, and your play mode is unchanged afterwards.



In **radio mode** the timer works the same way with the minute entries and the fade-out, but when it runs out the stream is **stopped** and there is no *Stop after current song* entry, because a radio has no song to wait for (see 11.4).

4. Search (main UI)

Key	Action	What it does
/	Search local folder	Opens the search box. The list updates live as you type . Press ENTER to keep the result, or ESC to cancel and restore the previous view.
/s: + query	Search online (YouTube)	Type s: followed by your query, then press ENTER . Online searches only run on ENTER , never per keystroke.
/p: + query	Search saved playlists	Type p: followed by part of a playlist name. The playlist list filters live. ENTER on a playlist row queues all of its tracks.
/f: + query	Search folders	Type f: followed by part of a folder name (or of <parent folder> <folder> , e.g. beatles abbey). The folder list filters live. ENTER on a folder row opens it in the LOCAL AUDIO FILES pane and lists all of its files, exactly like the f filter (c clears it again).
L (Shift+L)	Big list overlay	Floats a larger version of the list pane (LOCAL AUDIO FILES) over the main UI. See below.

In **radio mode** the search works the same way (fuzzy, live, **ESC** clears); it searches stations, and **p:** the saved station lists (see 11.5).

Local search details

- The search is **fuzzy**. For example "X Files" also finds "X-Files".
- It matches the file name, the artist, the embedded title tag and the album tag. Files whose tags have not been read yet can still be found by file name.
- Results are ranked purely by match quality, best first.
- While the search box is open, **↑/↓** move through the live preview. **←/→** move the text caret, and **SHIFT+←/→** marks text.
- A folder filter (**f**) keeps applying to search results.

Big list overlay (**SHIFT+L**)

Opens a large window, styled like the lyrics form (**1**), that shows the same list as the small pane (LOCAL AUDIO FILES, or the online / playlist results) with many more rows. It shares the cursor with the small pane, so both always point at the same track.

Key	Action
SHIFT+↓ / SHIFT+↑	Next / previous page (faster scrolling). At the end of the list the cursor jumps to the last / first entry.
↑ / ↓	Move one row
ESC or SHIFT+L	Close the overlay

Everything else keeps working from inside the overlay: **ENTER** plays, **T** cycles the sort mode, **f** / **c** set / clear the folder filter, **/** searches (the search bar is part of the overlay), **a** adds to the queue, **n** / **b** / **p** / seek / volume as usual, and **1** opens the lyrics form on top of it. The queue pane is hidden while the overlay is open, so its footer shows the current queue size (**queue: N**) together with a page counter. Full-screen menus (Settings, Playlists, ...) hide the overlay while they are open and it returns when they close.



Big list overlay can be open via **SHIFT+L** and closed via the same command or **ESC**. Fast scrolling (scroll per page) is possible via **SHIFT+↑/↓**.

5. Queue (main UI)

The queue is a list of tracks that play **before** the normal list continues. Press **TAB** to move focus into the queue panel when you want the arrow keys or **d**, **4**, **5**, **SHIFT+4**, **SHIFT+5** to work on it.

Key	Action	What it does
a	Add hovering track as next	With the list focused, puts the highlighted track at the front of the queue, so it plays next. Pressing a on several tracks in a row keeps their order: A, B, C play as A, B, C. On a playlist row it queues all of the playlist's tracks at the end instead. With the queue focused, a opens the bulk-add panel (see below).
e	Add hovering track to the end	With the list focused, adds the highlighted track to the end of the queue. On a playlist row it queues the whole playlist at the end. With the queue focused it only reminds you to focus the list first.
d	Remove hovering track from queue	Removes the highlighted queue item. Focus the queue with TAB first.
4	Move hovering queue item up	Moves the highlighted queue item one place up. Focus the queue first.
5	Move hovering queue item down	Moves the highlighted queue item one place down. Focus the queue first.

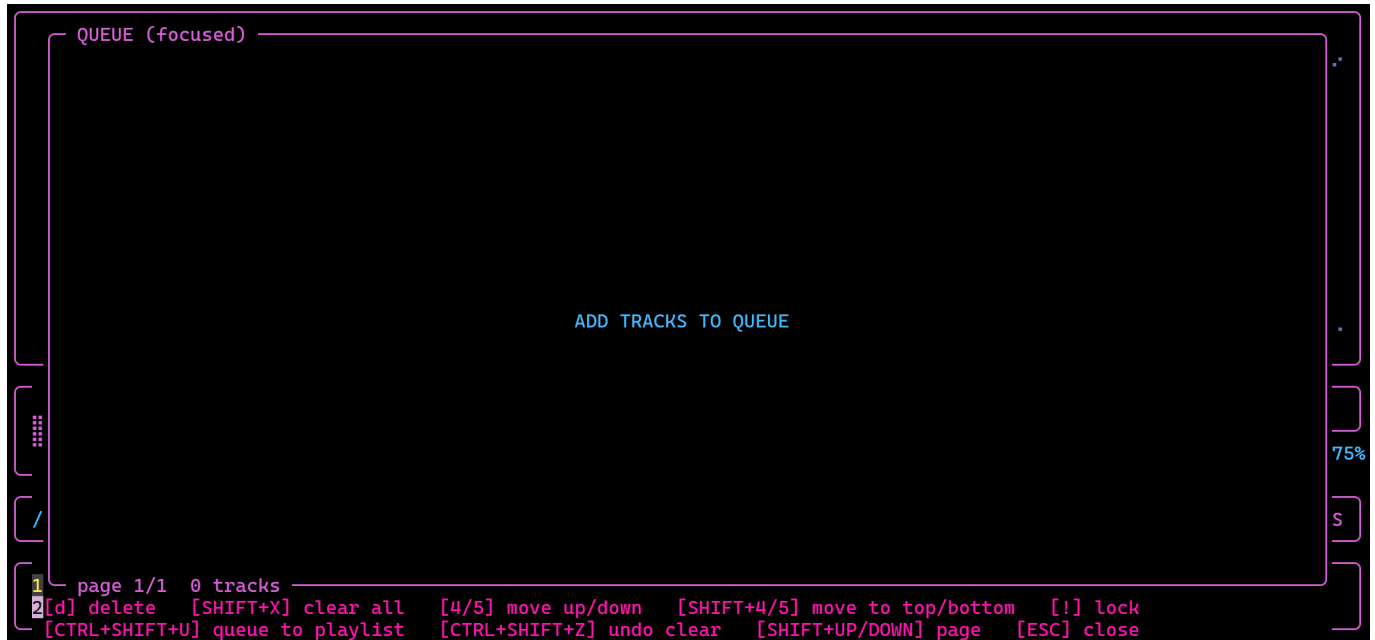
Key	Action	What it does
\$ (Shift+4)	Move to top	Moves the highlighted queue item to the very top of the queue.
% (Shift+5)	Move to bottom	Moves the highlighted queue item to the very bottom of the queue.
!	Lock / unlock the queue	The queue is locked by default : a played track moves to the end of the queue. Unlocked, it leaves the queue. See <i>Locked queue</i> below.
X (Shift+X)	Clear the whole queue	Asks "Want to clear queue?" first. See below.
CTRL+SHIFT+z	Undo the last queue clear	Brings back the queue that SHIFT+x cleared. See <i>Undo clear</i> below.
CTRL+SHIFT+u	Queue to playlist	Saves the queue's local tracks as a playlist. See <i>Queue to playlist</i> below.
K (Shift+K)	Big queue overlay	Floats a larger version of the QUEUE pane over the main UI. See below.

Big queue overlay (**SHIFT+k**)

The same idea as the big list overlay, for the queue: a large window that shows the QUEUE pane with many more rows. It is on **SHIFT+k** (and not on **q**) so that you cannot quit the app by accident. It shares the cursor with the small queue pane, and the queue is automatically focused while it is open, so the arrow keys move through the queue.

Key	Action
SHIFT+ARROW_DOWN / SHIFT+ARROW_UP	Next / previous page . At the end the cursor jumps to the last / first entry.
ARROW_UP / ARROW_DOWN	Move one row
4 / 5 (default)	Move the hovered track up / down in the queue
SHIFT+4 / SHIFT+5 (default)	Move the hovered track to the top / bottom of the queue
! (default)	Lock / unlock the queue
d	Remove the hovered track from the queue
a	Open the bulk-add panel (paste a playlist link), as with the queue focused
SHIFT+x	Clear the whole queue (asks first)
CTRL+SHIFT+z	Undo the last queue clear
CTRL+SHIFT+u	Save the queue as a playlist (opens the playlist editor)
ESC or SHIFT+k	Close the overlay (the previous focus is restored)

Only one of the two overlays can be open at a time: **SHIFT+k** while the list overlay is open switches to the queue overlay, and vice versa. Pressing **/** closes the queue overlay, because the search filters the list underneath. Playback keys (**n**, **b**, **p**, seek, volume) keep working. The bottom border of the frame shows the page counter and the number of tracks. All commands of the overlay are listed in a gray **legend below the frame** (**[d]** delete, **[SHIFT+x]** clear all, **[4/5]** move up/down, **[SHIFT+4/5]** move to top/bottom, **[!]** lock / **[!]** unlock, **[CTRL+SHIFT+u]** queue to playlist, **[CTRL+SHIFT+z]** undo clear, **[SHIFT+UP/DOWN]** page, **[ESC]** close).



Big list overlay can be open via **SHIFT+L** and closed via the same command or **ESC**. Fast scrolling (scroll per page) is possible via **SHIFT+↑/↓**.

Locked queue (!)

The queue is **locked by default**. A locked queue keeps all its tracks: when a track is played (by auto-advance or by **n**) it **moves to the end of the queue**, so the queue loops instead of draining, and the next track is always the one at the top (in shuffle mode a random queue item is picked and sent to the end). **d** and **SHIFT+x** still remove tracks, locking only stops tracks from disappearing by themselves. The panel title shows **QUEUE (locked)**.

Press **!** to **unlock**: a track then **leaves the queue** once it is played, and the queue runs empty. Press **!** again to lock it. The lock state is part of the saved session, so a session saved by an older version keeps the state it was saved with (press **!** once if it comes back unlocked). The play modes do not change this, with one exception: in **Q** (queue then stop) a locked queue is played through once and playback then stops instead of looping.

Undo clear (**CTRL+SHIFT+z**)

Brings back the queue that was cleared last with **SHIFT+x**. The restored tracks go in **front of** anything that was queued after the clear. There is **one** level of undo: after it is used (or before anything was cleared) the status line says that there is nothing to undo.

Queue to playlist (**CTRL+SHIFT+u**)

Opens the playlist editor (see [Playlists](#)) with the queue's tracks already in the new playlist and the **name field focused**: type a name and press **HOME** to save (the editor stays open, **ESC** leaves it). Playlists hold local files only, so **online (streamed) queue items are left out** and counted in the status line; duplicate files are added once. With an empty queue, or a queue with online tracks only, nothing opens and the status line says so.

Clear queue prompt (**SHIFT+x**)

The prompt starts on **No**, so an accidental **ENTER** never wipes the queue.

Key	Result
←	Highlight Yes
→	Highlight No
TAB	Toggle between Yes and No
ENTER	Take the highlighted answer
y	Yes: clear the queue
n, ESC or any other key	No: cancel

If the queue is already empty, the status line just says so. A cleared queue can be brought back with **CTRL+SHIFT+z** (see above).

Bulk add (**a** with the queue focused)

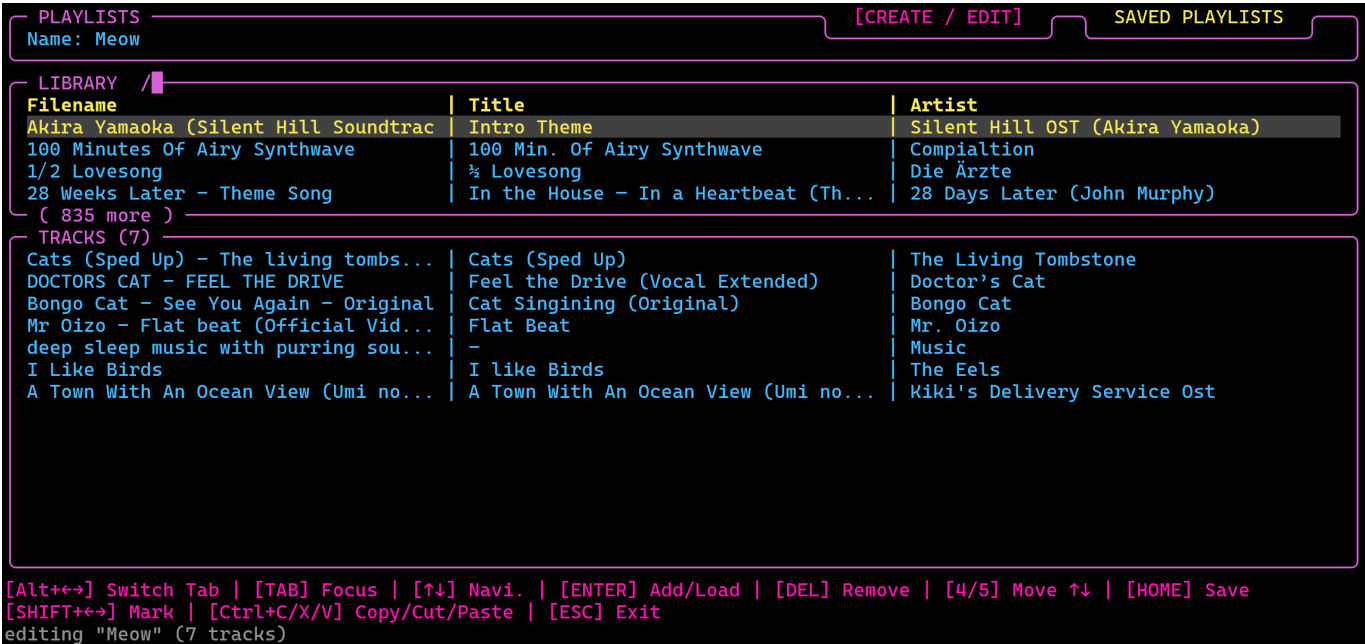
Paste a YouTube playlist link to queue tracks from it.

1. **Type or paste the link** and press **ENTER** to fetch it (**ESC** cancels).
2. Once the results appear: **↑/↓** move, **SPACE** stars or unstars a row, **a** queues **all** of them, and **ENTER** queues **only the starred** ones.
3. **ESC** throws everything away.

6. Playlists

P (Shift+P) opens the **playlist editor**, a full-screen overlay for building playlists from your local (or downloaded) tracks. It has two tabs: **Create/Edit** and **Saved Playlists**. Playlists are used from the main screen with **/p:** (see [Search](#)). The editor uses the same tab strip as the settings: the title and, on the Create/Edit tab, the **name field** (25 characters) sit on its top line, the tab names on the right.

Playlists are stored in **one** folder, set under **Settings** → **PATHS** → **PLAYLIST PATH**. Without it, the first local path plus **/playlists** is used. Changing the playlist path **copies** the existing playlists to the new folder; nothing is moved or deleted.



Create / Edit tab: the name field, the library picker with its search (/), and the tracks of the playlist being built.



Saved Playlists tab: the search field and the list of saved playlists with their track counts.

Key	What it does
P	Open Playlists (create / manage)
ALT+← / ALT+→	Switch between the Create/Edit tab and the Saved Playlists tab. Alt is used because plain arrows are needed for the text fields.
TAB	Cycle focus. On Create/Edit: name field → library picker → track list. On Saved Playlists: search box ↔ list.
↑ / ↓	Move through the focused list or picker
ENTER	Depends on focus. See the table below.
4 / 5	Move the highlighted track up or down in the playlist you are building

Key	What it does
D / DEL / BACKSPACE	Remove the highlighted track (track list focused). On the Saved Playlists tab, DEL deletes the selected playlist after a Yes/No confirmation.
HOME / Fn + ←	Save the playlist
SHIFT+← / SHIFT+→	Mark text in the name and search fields
CTRL+C / CTRL+X / CTRL+V	Copy, cut and paste text in those fields

What **ENTER** does in the playlist editor

Where	Result
Name field	Confirms the name and jumps to the library picker
Library picker	Adds the highlighted track to the playlist. (Typing in this pane filters the library live.)
Saved Playlists, search box	Moves focus to the list
Saved Playlists, list	Loads the selected playlist into the editor

Leaving

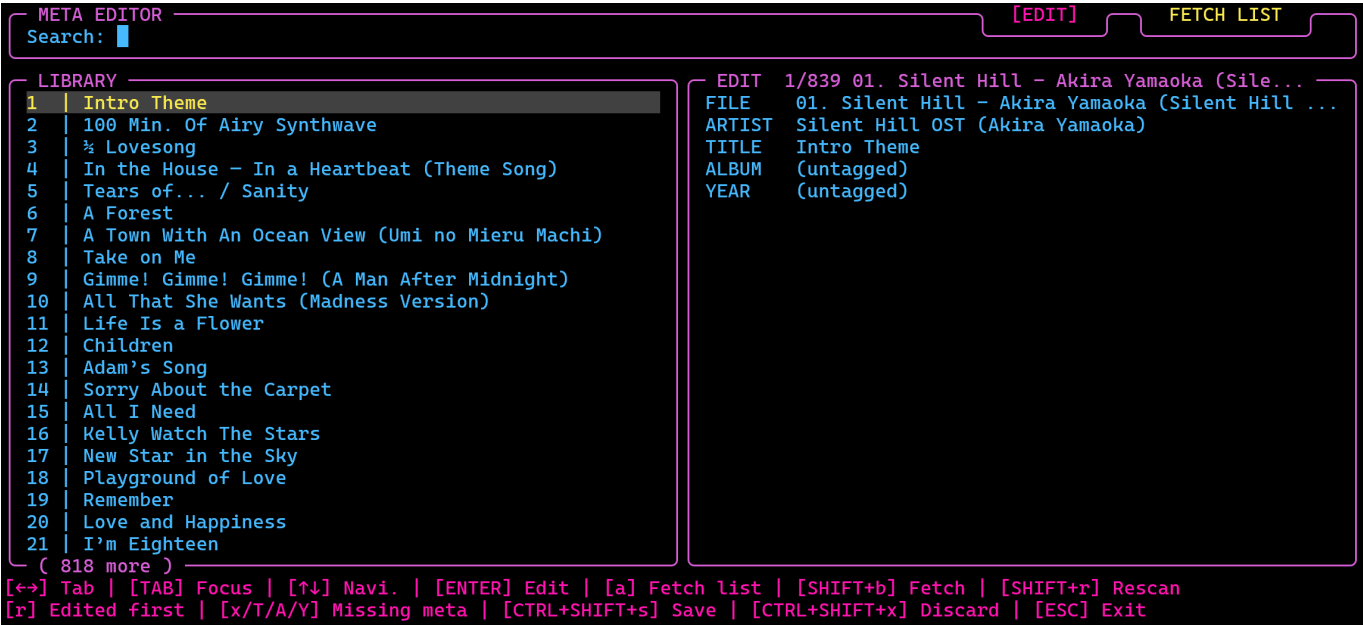
ESC closes the editor. If there are unsaved changes on the Create/Edit tab, it asks whether to save: **y** saves, **n** discards and leaves, **ESC** cancels the question and keeps editing.

7. Meta editor

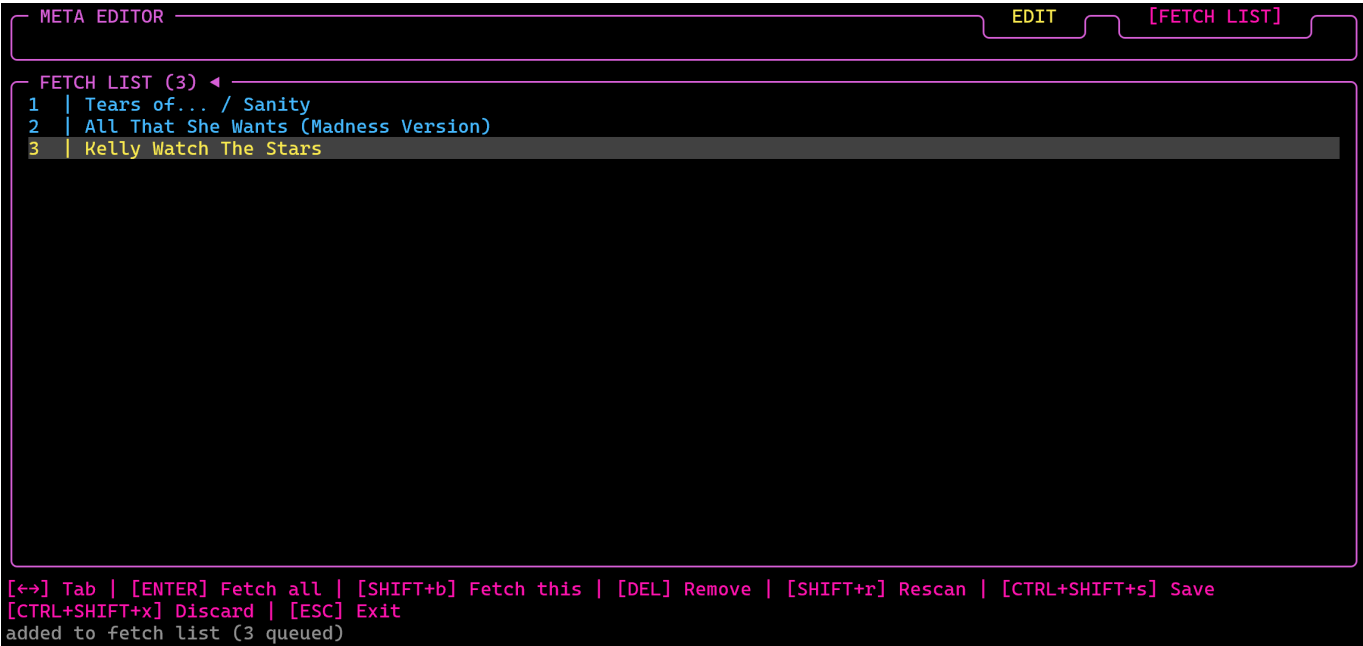
M (Shift+M) opens the **meta/tag editor** for changing a file's **file name**, **artist**, **title**, **album** and **year**, and for looking up missing tags with AcoustID (an audio-fingerprint service).

Important safety rules

- Editing never touches your files directly. All changes go into a **pending edit session**, which is autosaved after every keystroke to `~/.cache/mousiki/meta_session/`. Closing the editor, quitting, or even a crash keeps the session.
- Touched fields and the matching library rows are drawn in the **header colour**, so you can see what will be written.
- Only **CTRL+SHIFT+s** writes to the files, and it asks first.



Edit tab (the search field sits on the second line of the tab strip, left of the tab names): the search field, the library on the left, and the five fields (FILE, ARTIST, TITLE, ALBUM, YEAR) of the highlighted file on the right. The footer lists every key.



Fetch List tab: the titles queued for an AcoustID lookup. The status line below the footer confirms what was added.

Key	What it does
M	Open the meta editor
← / →	Switch between the Edit tab and the Fetch List tab. (While you are typing in a field, they move the text caret instead.)
TAB	Cycle panels on the Edit tab: search field → library → field editor
↑ / ↓	Move through the focused list, or between the five fields in the field editor

Key	What it does
ENTER	Depends on focus (see below). On the Fetch List tab it fetches metadata for the whole list.
SHIFT+← / SHIFT+→	Mark text in the field editor
CTRL+C / CTRL+X / CTRL+V	Copy, cut, paste in the field editor
a	Add the highlighted file to the fetch list (library focused)
r	Toggle edited files on top of the library pane
x	Filter the library to files missing any metadata (library pane focused; press again to clear)
SHIFT+t	Filter the library to files missing a title (press again to clear)
SHIFT+a	Filter the library to files missing an artist (press again to clear)
SHIFT+y	Filter the library to files missing a year (press again to clear)
SHIFT+b	Fetch metadata for the highlighted title via AcoustID (asks first)
DEL / d	Remove the highlighted title from the fetch list . It only takes a title off that list: it never deletes the file and does not touch pending edits. If the title is not on the fetch list, the status line says not on the fetch list .
CTRL+SHIFT+s	Apply all pending edits to the files (asks first)
CTRL+SHIFT+x	Discard all pending edits (asks first)
SHIFT+r	Rescan the library (library pane or fetch list focused), e.g. after new files arrived
ESC	Close the editor (the session is kept)

What **ENTER** does in the meta editor

Where	Result
Search field	Keeps the filter and moves to the library list
Library list	Starts editing the highlighted file's fields
Field editor	Finishes editing this field and goes back to the library
Fetch List tab	Fetch metadata for every title in the list (asks first)

Using the AcoustID lookup

- **SHIFT+b** looks up one title. It works from the meta editor and also directly from the **main list** (only for local files).
- **a** collects titles into the fetch list, and **ENTER** on the Fetch List tab runs them as a batch.

- Before anything is fetched you get the disclaimer that the result is not always accurate and previous metadata will be overwritten. Answer with **y**, **n** or **ESC**.
- Results only land in the **edit session**, never directly in the files. Low-confidence matches are reported as "no match" rather than written as wrong tags.
- Applying (**CTRL+SHIFT+s**) writes the tags without re-encoding the audio. A file name edit becomes a plain rename.

8. History

H (Shift+H) opens the **listening history** overlay, with three tabs. Nothing you do here changes your music.

Key	What it does
H	Open the history (and close it again). ESC and q also close it.
1 / 2 / 3	Jump to the tab: 1 History , 2 Top Tracks , 3 Habits
← / → / TAB	Move between tabs (on Top Tracks, TAB switches panes instead, see below)
↑ / ↓	Move the cursor in History and Top Tracks. On Habits they scroll.
r	On Top Tracks : flip between <i>most played first</i> and <i>least played first</i>
TAB	On Top Tracks : switch between the track list and the ADD TOP TRACKS TO QUEUE pane
ENTER	On a track in History or Top Tracks : play it right away (the overlay stays open and the footer says playing: ...). A local file that no longer exists is reported instead. In the ADD TOP TRACKS TO QUEUE pane: queue the top 10 / 25 / 50 / 100 tracks (whichever is selected with ↑/↓).

The three tabs

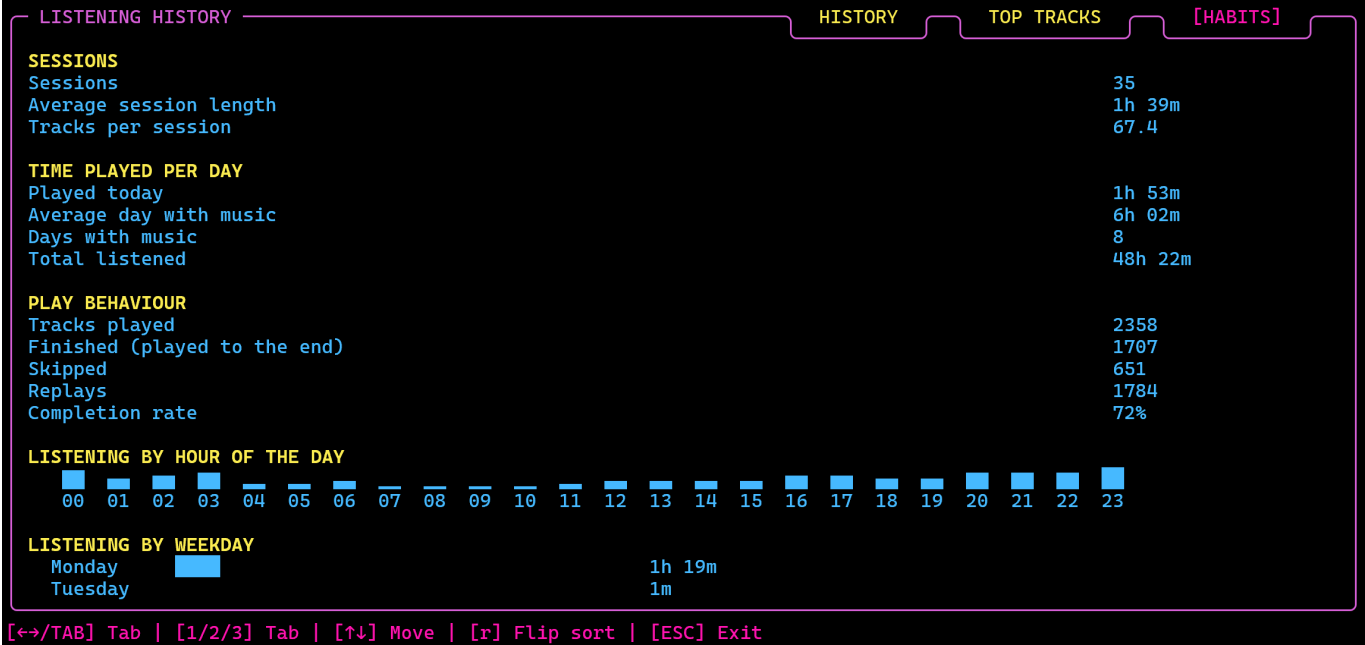
- **History**: the last 100 plays. **ENTER** plays the hovered one.
- **Top Tracks**: one row per title with its length and play count, sorted by play count. **ENTER** plays the hovered title.
- **Habits**: listening statistics, including average session length, listening time per day, tracks per session, skips, replays and completion rates.

LISTENING HISTORY			[HISTORY]	TOP TRACKS	HABITS
10-05 20:29	The Marketts - Out of Limits	2:05	done		
10-05 18:09	Cocteau Twins - In Our Angelhood	2:59	skip		
10-05 18:05	First Aid Kit - My Silver Lining	3:50	done		
10-05 18:05	Jimi Hendrix - Little Wing	3:15	skip		
10-05 18:02	Cocteau Twins - Sugar Hiccup	3:42	done		
10-05 17:58	Cowboy Bebop OST シートベルツ - WO QUI NON COIN	3:43	done		
10-05 17:58	Cowboy Bebop OST シートベルツ - SPOKEY DOKEY	4:05	skip		
10-05 17:54	Silent Hill F OST - TSUKIYONONERIME	3:55	done		
10-05 17:48	Kofelgschroa - Schlaflied	5:17	done		
10-05 17:44	Voodoo Jürgens - Heite Grob Ma Tote Aus	4:10	done		
10-05 17:44	Voodoo Jürgens - Heite Grob Ma Tote Aus	4:10	skip		
10-05 17:44	Voodoo Jürgens - Gitti	3:07	skip		
10-05 17:44	Kustbandet - Puttin' on the Ritz	4:33	skip		
10-05 17:44	Die Ärzt - Deine Schuld	3:34	skip		
10-05 17:44	Berlin - Take My Breath Away	4:11	skip		
10-05 17:44	Frank OST - I Love You All	3:51	skip		
10-05 17:43	Jerobeam Fenderson & Adox - Asteroids	3:57	skip		
10-05 17:36	Philip Glass - Glassworks: Opening	6:24	done		
10-05 17:36	blink-182 - Going Away to College	2:59	skip		
10-05 17:31	M O O N - Hydrogen	4:55	skip		
10-05 17:31	Earth, Wind & Fire - September	3:35	skip		
10-05 17:31	Herbert Grönemeyer - Der Weg	4:16	skip		
10-05 14:41	Placebo - Every You, Every Me	3:35	done		
10-05 14:41	Helge Schneider - Katzenklo	2:58	skip		
10-05 14:41	MGMT - Electric Feel Live	5:33	skip		
1000 plays (newest 100 shown)					
[←/TAB] Tab [1/2/3] Tab [↑↓] Move [r] Flip sort [ESC] Exit					

History tab: when each track was played, its title, its length and its state (*PLAY* = playing now, *done* = played to the end, *skip* = skipped).

LISTENING HISTORY			HISTORY	[TOP TRACKS]	HABITS
Cats (Sped Up)		1:04	14		
Slingshot/Hypersleep		5:59	13		
TSUKIYONONERIME		3:55	12		
I like Birds		2:31	12		
Machine Gun		4:32	12		
Cat Singining (Original)		2:09	11		
½ Lovesong		3:54	10		
Mayoi Uta		2:58	9		
Asteroids		3:57	9		
Rhythm Shift		5:04	8		
Intro		2:07	8		
In the House - In a Heartbeat (Theme Song)		4:17	7		
Nina Hagen - Du hast den Farbfilm vergessen 1974		2:31	7		
The Fellowship		5:25	6		
Act1-tristram		7:40	6		
Nine Million Bicycles		3:13	6		
Tonight, Tonight		4:18	6		
Schrooms		6:02	6		
The View From the Afternoon		4:34	6		
most played first					
ADD TOP TRACKS TO QUEUE					
Top 10 tracks					
Top 25 tracks					
Top 50 tracks					
Top 100 tracks					
[←/→] Tab [1/2/3] Tab [TAB] Switch pane [↑↓] Move [ENTER] Add to queue [r] Flip sort [ESC] Exit					

Top Tracks tab: titles by play count, with the **ADD TOP TRACKS TO QUEUE** pane underneath.



Habits tab: sessions, time played per day, and play behaviour.

The list cursor behaves like the one of the local file list: the column header stays in place and the window only scrolls when the cursor leaves it.

The history is stored in `history.json`. The folder is set under **Settings** → **PATHS** → **HISTORY PATH** (one folder). If the new folder already holds a `history.json` it is used, otherwise the current one is copied there.

In **radio mode** the radio has its own history of channels, see 11.11.

Adding top tracks to the queue

- 1. Press 2 for Top Tracks.
- 2. Press TAB to move to the lower pane.
- 3. Use ↑/↓ to pick 10, 25, 50 or 100.
- 4. Press ENTER.

"Top N" always means the **N most-played titles**, even if you flipped the list with r. Files that have been moved or deleted since they were played are skipped, and the status line reports how many were queued and how many were missing. Online tracks are queued as online tracks.

9. Downloads

Key	Action	What it does
y	Save stream	Saves the currently playing streamed track into your download folder (Settings → PATHS → DOWNLOAD PATH , or <code>~/.cache/mousiki</code> if none is set). The file is named <code>Title - Artist.ext</code> , the cached copy is removed, and the library refreshes so the file appears as a local track.

Status messages:

- saved to <path>: success

- **already saved:** <name>: a file with that name is already in the folder
- **not a cached stream:** the current track is a regular local file, so there is nothing to download

10. Settings (individual tabs)

Press **s** on the main screen to open **Settings**. It has six tabs: **COLORS**, **ON/OFF**, **ANIMATION**, **PATHS**, **REFERENCE** and **ABOUT APP**. Settings always open on the first tab. The footer shows **[TAB] Switch | [↑↓↔] Navigate/Cycle | [ENTER] Edit | [s] Save | [ESC/q] Discard**, and the line below it reports what just changed. While there are changes that are not saved yet, that line shows a green *** unsaved changes (saved with S or when you leave)** note.

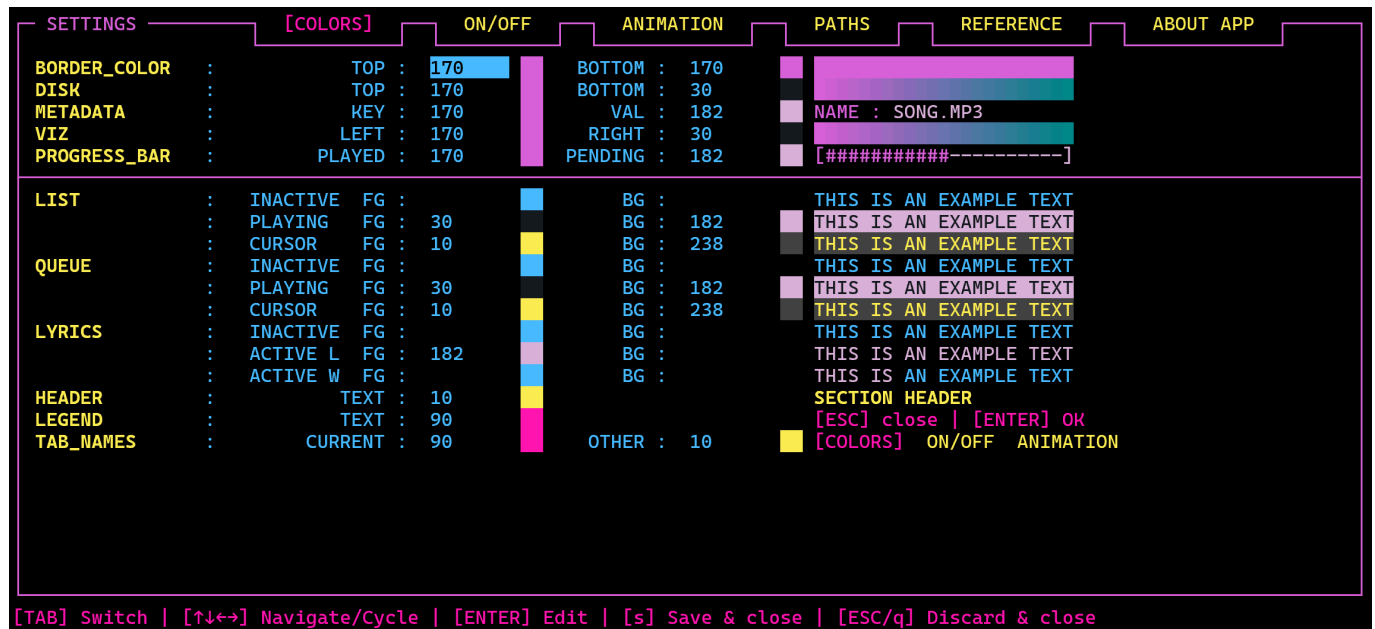
Moving around and editing (all tabs)

Key	What it does
TAB	Next tab (wraps from ABOUT APP back to COLORS). The cursor returns to the first row.
↑ / ↓	Previous or next row. On ABOUT APP they scroll the text.
← / →	On a row with a fixed list of values (switches, sliders, choices), steps through the values and applies the change immediately . On COLORS they move between the first and second cell of a row instead.
ENTER	Edits the value in place as free text. Not available on ABOUT APP or on the read-only rows of REFERENCE. On PATHS it edits the selected path, or adds one on a + new path row.
s	Saves to config.txt and closes Settings.
ESC / q	Discards every change made since Settings were opened (they are put back as they were) and closes Settings.

Good to know

- Every change is **live**. It takes effect as soon as you make it, so you can see and hear it while you are still in Settings.
- Only **s** writes the changes to **config.txt**. If you leave with **ESC** or **q** instead, everything you changed on the screen, including paths, is put back as it was when you opened Settings. The radio's settings work the same way (see 11.12).
- **Text editing** (after **ENTER**): **←/→** move the caret, **SHIFT+←/→** mark text, **HOME/END** jump, **DEL/BACKSPACE** delete, **CTRL+C/X/V** copy, cut and paste. **ENTER** confirms, **ESC** cancels and discards the edit. Ordinary fields hold up to 18 characters, folder paths up to 240.

Tab 1: COLORS



The **COLORS** tab with the live preview on the right.

Sets the colours of the interface. There are **16 rows**, each with a name (drawn in the **header colour**), one or two value cells, a colour swatch next to each value and a **live preview** on the right.

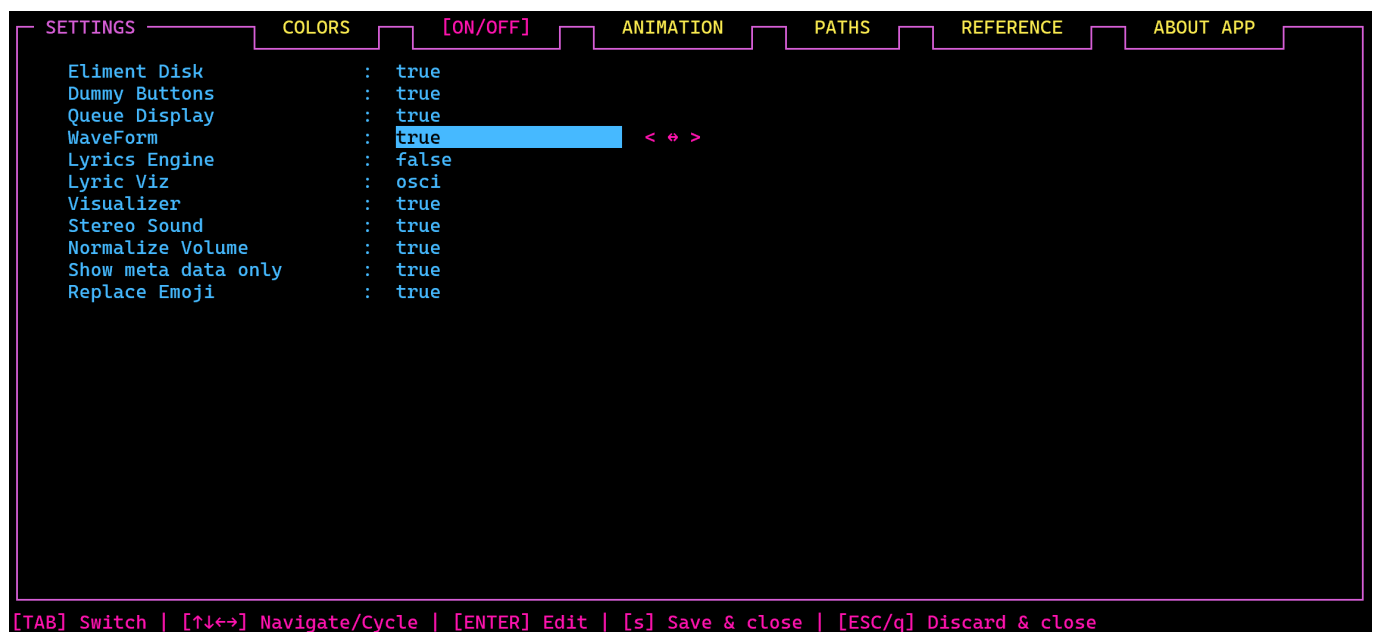
Values are numbers from the 256-colour terminal palette (1–255). 0 or an empty field means "no colour", so the terminal's own default is used. Values in the ranges 30–47 and 90–107 are used as direct terminal colour codes.

Row	First cell	Second cell	What it colours
BORDER_COLOR	TOP	BOTTOM	The frame lines, fading from top to bottom.
DISK	TOP	BOTTOM	The spinning disk (gradient).
METADATA	KEY	VAL	The labels and the values in the metadata panel.
VIZ	LEFT	RIGHT	The visualizer bars (gradient).
PROGRESS_BAR	PLAYED	PENDING	The played and the remaining part of the progress bar.
LIST	INACTIVE FG	BG	Ordinary rows of the track list (text / background).
	PLAYING FG	BG	The row of the track that is playing.
	CURSOR FG	BG	The highlighted (hovering) row.
QUEUE	INACTIVE FG	BG	Ordinary rows of the queue.
	PLAYING FG	BG	The queue row that is playing.

Row	First cell	Second cell	What it colours
	CURSOR FG	BG	The highlighted queue row.
LYRICS	INACTIVE FG	BG	Lyric lines that are not active.
	ACTIVE L FG	BG	The active line.
	ACTIVE W FG	BG	The active word.
HEADER	TEXT	none	The section titles in Paths and Reference. Text colour only, no background.
LEGEND	TEXT	none	The key command legends: the hint lines such as <code>[ESC]</code> <code>close</code> at the bottom of the Settings, the big list and queue overlays (<code>SHIFT+1</code> / <code>SHIFT+k</code>), the playlist editor, the meta editor and the listening history, plus the small <code>< ⇄ ></code> and note hints inside the Settings. Text colour only, no background. Default <code>90</code> (the grey they have always had), <code>0</code> = the terminal's own text colour. Also available as <code>ColorLegend=</code> in <code>config.txt</code> .
TAB_NAMES	CURRENT	OTHER	The tab names of Settings and of the playlist, meta and history menus: the current tab (drawn as <code>[NAME]</code>) and the others. Text colour only. Also <code>ColorTabCurrent=</code> / <code>ColorTabOther=</code> in <code>config.txt</code> .

FG is the text colour, BG the background. Use `←/→` to pick the cell, then `ENTER` to type a new number.

Tab 2: ON/OFF



The ON/OFF tab: a list of switches. (The folder settings are on the PATHS tab.)

This tab is a list of **switches** (change them with $\leftrightarrow$). Most are true/false, but **Lyric Viz** picks between **sphere** and **osci**. The folder settings (LOCAL PATH, DOWNLOAD PATH, PLAYLIST PATH, HISTORY PATH) are on the **PATHS** tab.

Setting	What it does
Eliment Disk	Shows or hides the spinning disk in the player area.
Dummy Buttons	Shows or hides the three decorative buttons next to the progress bar.
Queue Display	Shows or hides the Queue panel.
WaveForm	Shows or hides the waveform. With it off, a plain bar is drawn instead.
Lyrics Engine	Turns lyric fetching and display on or off. + also switches this: it cycles lyrics (on) → sphere (off) → oscilloscope (off).
Lyric Viz	Which visual fills the lyrics area while a track is loaded and there are no lyrics to show: sphere (the audio-reactive ball) or osci (the XY oscilloscope, see <i>The oscilloscope</i> above). Both are drawn in the VIZ colors (Settings → Colors → VIZ). Replaces the old <i>Lyric Ball</i> on/off switch. The oscilloscope's look is tuned with SHIFT+o .
Visualizer	Shows or hides the spectrum visualizer.
Stereo Sound	On plays in stereo (about twice the memory per loaded track), off folds left and right into mono. Turning it off is immediate. Turning it on applies from the next track.
Normalize Volume	Loudness normalization on or off. Same as the v key. Target and boost are set with the SHIFT+v overlay.
Show meta data only	Rows show the embedded title tag instead of the file name. Same as SHIFT+n . The list is re-sorted straight away.
Replace Emoji	An emoji in a title is drawn as a single ? , so the frame borders stay aligned. Off draws the real emoji. (ReplaceEmoji= in config.txt .)

Tab 3: ANIMATION



The ANIMATION tab. The < ⇄ > hint shows that ⇄ cycle the value.

All rows are cycled with ⇄ (or typed after ENTER).

Setting	Values	What it does
Vis. Fluidity	1–10	How the visualizer bars rise . It affects only the rising motion.
Waveform Style	raw, smooth	Waveform drawing style. Same as the w key.
Disk Speed	0.01, 0.05, 0.10, 0.17, 0.25, 0.50, 0.75, 1.00	How fast the disk spins.
Playback Mode	list, loop, shuffle, stop, queue then stop	The play mode. Same as the m key (loop is the mode shown as <i>repeat</i>).
Vis. Degradation	1–10	How quickly bars fall . 1 is a slow, VU-meter-like fade, 10 a near-instant cutoff.
Vis. Viscosity	1–10	How strongly the bar motion is damped and smoothed between neighbouring bars.
Lyrics Alignment	left, center, right	Where lyric lines sit in their area.
Lyrics Animation	full, word by word, line by line, letter by letter, active line only, active word only	How lyrics are revealed and highlighted as the song plays.

Tab 4: PATHS

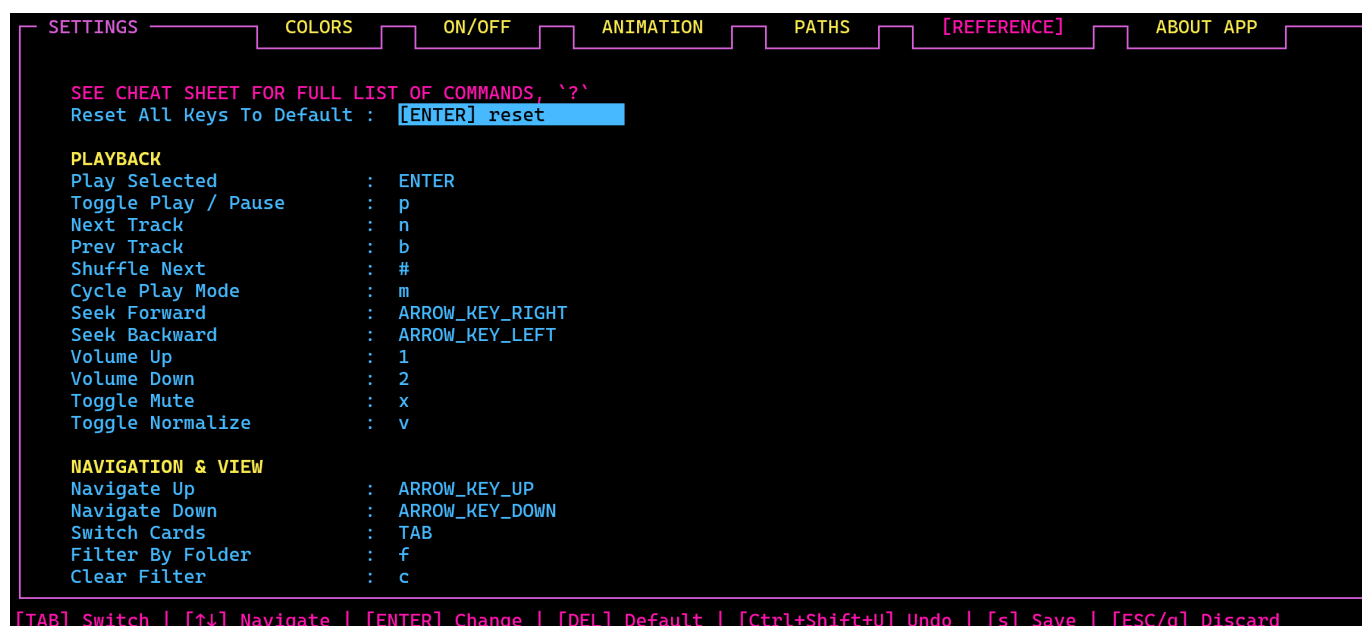
The PATHS tab: the folders Mousiki reads music from, downloads to, and keeps playlists and the history in. (There is no screenshot for this tab yet.)

Four sections, each under its header in the header colour. Move onto a row and press **ENTER** to edit it. The tab scrolls with the cursor, so a short terminal is fine.

Section	Rows	What it does
LOCAL PATH	Local Path 1, 2, ... plus + new path	The folders scanned for music. ENTER edits one. + new path (ENTER) adds an empty line and opens it for typing. Committing a change rescans the library immediately .
DOWNLOAD PATH	one row	Where y (Save stream) puts downloaded tracks. Until you set one it shows the default cache folder (<code>~/ .cache/mousiki</code>). It is added to the scanned folders automatically, so you do not repeat it as a local path. The radio uses the same folder by default.
PLAYLIST PATH	one row	The one folder playlists are loaded from, saved to and deleted in. If none is set, the first local path plus <code>/playlists</code> is used. Under the path a note says that changing it copies the existing playlists to the new folder.
HISTORY PATH	one row	The one folder that holds the listening history (<code>history.json</code>). Under the path a note says that an existing <code>history.json</code> in the new folder is used, otherwise the current one is copied there.

DOWNLOAD PATH, PLAYLIST PATH and HISTORY PATH are single paths: their name sits on the row itself, followed by `:` and the folder, and there is no + new path line. Paths accept `~` and `%USERPROFILE%` shortcuts, and both slash directions on Windows. Emptying a path line and pressing **ENTER** removes that path (for the single paths: resets it to the default). Changed folders only take effect for good when you save with **s**; with **ESC** or **q** they are put back.

Tab 5: REFERENCE



The REFERENCE tab: the rebindable hotkeys (scroll for the rest).

The longest tab. It scrolls as one list and has two parts: the hotkeys, then the font map.

Hotkeys (editable). A grey note at the top points to the cheat sheet (?), and the rebindable commands are listed under the headers PLAYBACK, NAVIGATION & VIEW, SEARCH, QUEUE, PLAYLISTS, META EDITOR, HISTORY, DOWNLOADS and SYSTEM. Each row shows a label and the key currently bound to it.

- Press **ENTER** on a row, type the new key, and press **ENTER** again.
- A key is written as the character itself (n, T, #, +) or as a name: **ENTER**, **TAB**, **SPACE**, **ESC**, **BACKSPACE**, **ARROW_KEY_UP**, **ARROW_KEY_DOWN**, **ARROW_KEY_LEFT**, **ARROW_KEY_RIGHT**.
- If the key is **already used by another action**, the change is refused with **KEY "x" ALREADY USED BY <action> -- try another key**, and you can type another one.
- The search prefixes (/ , /s: , /p:) appear here too and are edited the same way.
- Keys that are **not** rebindable (**ESC**, **SHIFT+b**, the playlist and meta editors' own keys, **CTRL+SHIFT+s/X**, **CTRL+SHIFT+z/U**, **ALT+l**) are not listed. The cheat sheet shows those.

FONT / CHARACTER MAP (read-only). Shows the **A = A**, **a** table from **config.txt**, which lets you re-font the interface with fancy Unicode letters without changing the terminal font. It cannot be edited here. Edit the **font_en={ ... }** block in **config.txt** while the app is closed.

Settings that exist (only) in **config.txt**

Key in config.txt	What it does
ReplaceEmoji	true draws an emoji in a title as a single ? so box borders stay aligned. false draws the real emoji.
ConsoleVerbosity	basic logs every command the app runs and its raw output. verbose adds internal and OS-level events.
AutoSave	Resumes the exact song, position, queue and play mode at the next launch.
AutoSaveIndicator , AutoSaveChr , AutoSaveIndicatorType , AutoSaveC1 , AutoSaveC2	The small autosave indicator: whether it shows, its character, blink or color style, and the two pulse colours.
OsciDecay , OsciDotThreshold , OsciTailBrightness and the other Osci<name>= / OsciImage<name>= lines, OsciStyle , OsciImageProtocol	The oscilloscope's values (afterglow 0.00 – 0.99, dot threshold 0.01 – 1.00, tail brightness 0.00 – 1.00, Z axis, trace length, palette ...). Osci... belongs to the braille style, OsciImage... to the image style. Normally changed with the SHIFT+o overlay, which writes them here. Values outside the range are limited to it when the file is loaded.
NormalizeVolume , NormalizeTargetLufs , NormalizeMaxBoostDb	Loudness normalization on or off, its target level (-40 to 0 LUFS, default -16) and the most a quiet track may be raised (0 to 24 dB, default 9). Normally changed with the SHIFT+v overlay, which writes them here. Values outside the range are limited to it when the file is loaded.
SleepFade	Whether the sleep timer fades the volume out over the last 10 % of its time (default true).

Key in config.txt	What it does
PlaylistsPath , HistoryPath	The playlist folder and the listening history folder (one each; a second PlaylistsPath line is ignored). Normally set under Settings → PATHS .
ColorHeader , ColorLegend , ColorTabCurrent , ColorTabOther	The header, legend and tab-name colours (also on the COLORS tab).
AutoSaveDelayInSec	How often the session snapshot is saved (default 30 seconds).
UpperLeftCorner , Vertical , Horizontal , Seprator , ListSeparator and the other border entries	The characters used to draw frames and the list column separator.
EqualizerEnabled , EqualizerBands	Whether the equalizer is on, and its ten band gains in dB (−12 to 12) for 31, 62, 125, 250, 500 Hz, 1, 2, 4, 8 and 16 kHz, for example EqualizerBands=0,3,-2,0,0,0,0,0,0,0 . Normally changed with the SHIFT+e overlay, which writes them here. Values outside the range are limited to it. A line with fewer or more than ten valid numbers is ignored.
EqualizerPreset	One custom preset per line: the ten gains, a , then the name, for example EqualizerPreset=4,3,1,0,-1,0,1,2,3,4 My Mix . The gains use the same band order as EqualizerBands . Created and deleted with S and DEL / X in the SHIFT+e overlay, which rewrites these lines. If you edit them by hand: a line without a , with an empty name, with the name of a built-in preset, with a name that appears twice, or with fewer or more than ten valid gains is ignored, and only the first 24 presets are used.

11. Radio mode

Besides the music player, Mousiki contains an **online radio**. It is tuned like an old radio set: a frequency band with a needle, an **ON AIR** sign while a station is live, 16 quick-tune presets and a search for stations all over the world. The radio lives in the same program but has its **own audio path, its own settings (radio_config.txt) and its own files**; nothing is shared with the player's **config.txt**.

Chapters 1 to 10 describe the music player. **This chapter only describes what is new in the radio or different from the player.** Everything the two modes have in common (equalizer, oscilloscope, loudness normalization, sleep timer, text fields, the settings screen and so on) is explained once in the chapters above, and [section 11.4](#) lists the few places where the radio behaves differently.

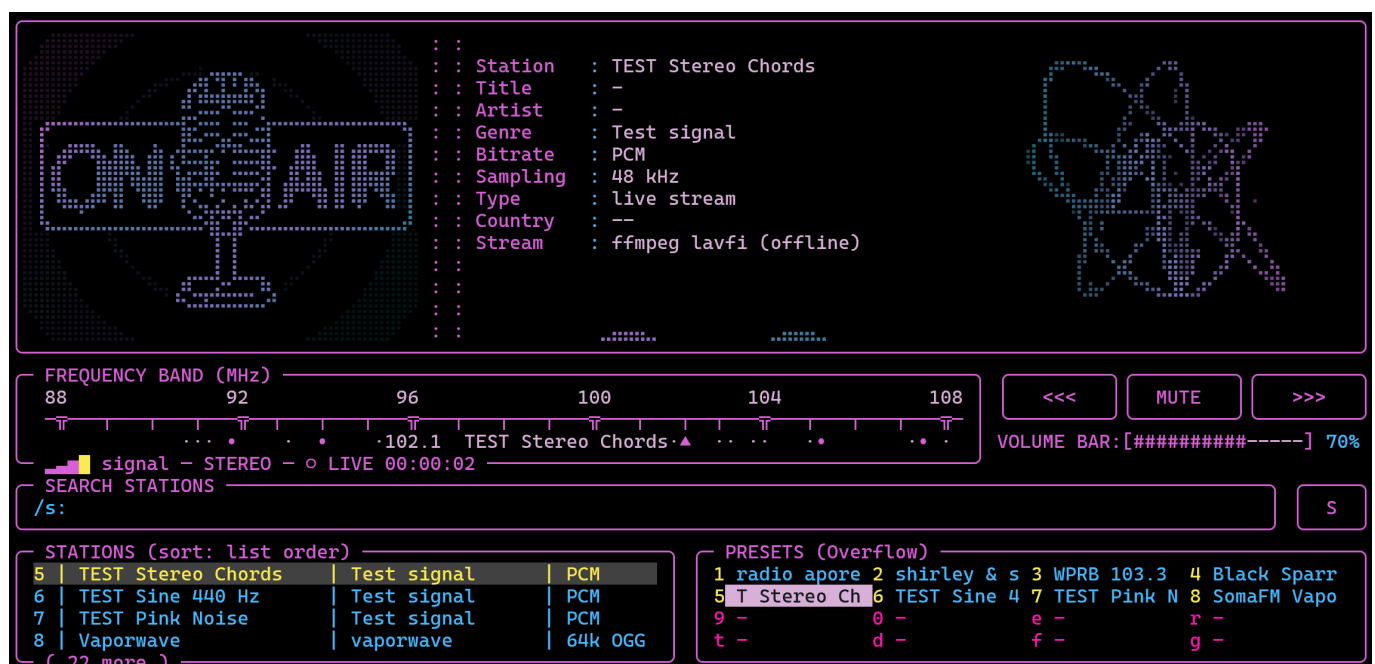
Requirements: **ffmpeg** (decodes the streams, also needed by the player), **curl** for the Radio Browser search, and a terminal of at least **120 x 30** characters.

11.1 Switching between player and radio

Press **SHIFT** and **+** (this types the ***** character) to switch to the other mode, in the player and in the radio. The first line of the cheat sheet (**?**) of both modes shows the combination that fits **your keyboard layout** (detected automatically, **MOUSIKI_KEYBOARD=us|de|fr|...** overrides it). The key is fixed and cannot be rebound.

- **Player** → **radio**: the player is **paused and kept in memory** with its queue, position and screen exactly as they were.
- **Radio** → **player**: the radio is **closed completely** (threads, audio device, buffers), so it only uses resources while you are in it. The player comes back instantly, without a loading screen.
- Files added to your music folders while you were in the radio are not known to the player yet: press **SHIFT+r** to rescan the library (see chapter 1).
- **q** (or **CTRL+c**) in the radio quits the program; both modes end.

11.2 The radio screen



The radio's main screen with a test station tuned.

From top to bottom:

- **Top pane.** The **ON AIR** sign (the **OFF AIR** sign while nothing is live) with a colour wave, the **station info** (station, title, artist, genre, bitrate, sampling rate, type, country, stream) and the **oscilloscope** or the audio-reactive **sphere** on the right (o switches, see below). A spectrum analyser sits under the station info.
- **FREQUENCY BAND (MHz).** A tuning dial. The needle shows the tuned station, small dots mark the other stations of your list (each station may carry its own dial frequency). The line underneath shows the signal strength bars, **STEREO** or **MONO**, **LIVE** with the time since you tuned in, and **REC mm:ss** while you record.
- **Volume bar** and the three decorative buttons next to the dial.
- **SEARCH STATIONS** with the **play mode letter** on its right (**S** shuffle or **L** list, **m** toggles; it only affects **b**).
- **STATIONS** (your station list) and **PRESETS** (the 16 slots of the active preset) side by side.

The frame is as tall as the terminal. A wider terminal widens the top pane and the search box, a taller one gives rows to STATIONS and PRESETS. With only four list rows the 16 presets switch to four columns.

11.3 Keys on the main screen

All of them are also in the radio's own cheat sheet (?), categorized and scrollable). Keys that are not hard coded can be rebound under **Settings** → **REFERENCE** (see 11.12). Letters are **case sensitive** in the radio: **p** is a preset key, **R** reconnects.

Key	Action
↑ / ↓	Move in the station list
ENTER	Tune the hovered station
n / b	Next / previous channel. b follows the mode letter: in S it goes back to the channel played before, in L to the one before it in the list.
#	A random channel (never the one already tuned)
m	Mode S shuffle ↔ L list (only affects b)
1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 0 e r t d f g	Recall slot 1 to 16 of the active preset
SHIFT+← / SHIFT+→	Previous / next preset
/	Search (see 11.5)
p	Mute / unmute. With no channel loaded it tunes the hovered station like ENTER .
+ / -	Volume
R	Reconnect the tuned station
x	Stop
SHIFT+t	Sort stations: list order ↔ name A-Z
o	Scope block: oscilloscope ↔ sphere
v / SHIFT+v	Loudness normalization on/off / its overlay
SHIFT+e	Equalizer overlay
SHIFT+o	Oscilloscope tuning overlay
SHIFT+z	Sleep timer
y	Record the tuned stream (see 11.10)
SHIFT+k / SHIFT+s / SHIFT+p	PRESETS menu / RADIO BROWSER / STATION LISTS
SHIFT+l	Big STATIONS overlay
h	Listening history

Key	Action
S	Settings
?	Cheat sheet
SHIFT+ +	Switch to the music player
q / CTRL+c	Quit

11.4 What the radio shares with the player

The following features exist in both modes, with the same keys and the same overlays. They are described in the chapters named in the table; only the differences are listed here.

Feature	Where it is described	What is different in the radio
Equalizer (SHIFT+e)	Chapter 2, <i>Equalizer overlay</i>	Same overlay, same 12 presets and keys. It is applied to the stream before volume and normalization and is stored separately in <code>radio_config.txt</code> (<code>EqualizerEnabled</code> , <code>EqualizerBands</code> , <code>EqualizerPreset=</code>), so the radio and the player can use different curves and custom presets. There is no conflict with the preset key <code>e</code> : the radio tells <code>e</code> and SHIFT+e apart.
Oscilloscope (SHIFT+o) and the lyric visual	Chapter 3, <i>The oscilloscope and Oscilloscope tuning overlay</i>	Same scope, same overlay rows, braille and image style included. In the radio the scope sits right of the station info instead of in the lyrics area, and <code>o</code> switches between oscilloscope and sphere. The radio has its own copy of the scope code and its own values in <code>radio_config.txt</code> (<code>OsciStyle=</code> , <code>Osci<name>=</code> , <code>OsciImage<name>=</code>). Image-style environment variables are <code>MOUSIKI_RADIO_GFX</code> and <code>MOUSIKI_RADIO_CELLPX</code> instead of <code>MOUSIKI_GFX</code> / <code>MOUSIKI_CELLPX</code> .
Loudness normalization (v , SHIFT+v)	Chapter 2 and <i>Loudness normalization overlay</i>	Same overlay, range and gating. A live stream has no end, so the loudness is measured since you tuned in and the gain glides in over about a second. Settings: <code>radio_config.txt</code> .
Sleep timer (SHIFT+z)	Chapter 3, <i>Sleep timer overlay</i>	Same minute entries (15 / 30 / 60 / 90 / 120). When the time is up the stream is stopped (a radio has no song to wait for), and there is no "Stop after current song" entry. The fade-out works the same way.
Search	Chapter 4	Fuzzy and typo tolerant like the player's. <code>- _ . /</code> count as spaces. With a query the best match comes first; SHIFT+t (A-Z) overrides that order. The Radio Browser menu searches on the server and is not fuzzy.

Feature	Where it is described	What is different in the radio
Text fields	<i>Before you start</i> and the editors' chapters	Same editing keys in every field: ←/→ caret, SHIFT+←/→ mark, HOME/END , DEL / BACKSPACE , CTRL+C/X/V . While a text field has the keyboard CTRL+c copies instead of quitting and SHIFT+←/→ marks text instead of switching the preset.
Lists	Chapter 3	The window only moves when the cursor leaves it. A hovered row that is too long scrolls as a marquee.
Playlist-style menus	Chapter 6	The STATION LISTS menu is built like the playlist editor, the PRESETS menu is laid out like it.
Listening history	Chapter 8	The radio has its own history with channels instead of tracks (see 11.11).
Settings	Chapter 10	Same frame and tab strip, but its own file, radio_config.txt (see 11.12).
Cheat sheet, rebinding	Chapter 1 and <i>Settings → REFERENCE</i>	Own list of keys, rebindable under the radio's Settings → REFERENCE.

11.5 Searching: stations, station lists and **p**:

/ opens the search box under the frequency band. The list filters live as you type; **ENTER** tunes the hovered hit and **ESC** clears the search.

Typed in the empty box	What it does
(a name, genre or country)	Filters the STATIONS pane
s :	Back to searching stations (the default)
p :	Searches the saved station lists (see 11.8): the STATIONS pane turns into STATION LISTS and filters live. ENTER fills the STATIONS pane with that list's stations and tunes its first station .

While a list is shown, the pane title reads **STATIONS (LIST: name - ESC: all)** and its rows are numbered by position in the list. **n, b and # surf only through the stations of that list**, in the list's order. **ESC** clears a search that is still in the box; the next **ESC** returns to all stations, and surfing covers every station again. The station list itself is not affected by the search.

11.6 PRESETS menu (**SHIFT+k**)

A **preset** is a named set of 16 station slots on the keys **1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 0 e r t d f g**. You can keep as many presets as you like. The active one is shown in the title of the PRESETS pane (**PRESETS (Morning)**), and **SHIFT+←/→** switches to the previous / next one from the main screen.

The full-screen menu is laid out like the player's playlist menu, from top to bottom: **SEARCH STATION / SEARCH PRESET** (**s**: filters stations, **p**: presets), **SELECT PRESET** (names in four columns) and **STATIONS** beside **PRESETS** (the 16 slots of the active preset). A small ◀ behind a pane's title shows which pane has the keyboard.

Key	Where	What it does
TAB	anywhere	Next pane: SEARCH → SELECT PRESET → STATIONS
↑ ↓ ↔ (or j k h l)	SELECT PRESET / STATIONS	Move
ENTER	STATIONS	Tune the hovered station
ENTER	SELECT PRESET	Open the hovered preset and tune its first filled slot
ENTER	search	Tune the hovered station / open the hovered preset, then jump to that pane
SHIFT+n / SHIFT+c	SELECT PRESET	New preset / rename the hovered one (a small name box: ENTER applies, ESC cancels)
SHIFT+d	SELECT PRESET	Delete the hovered preset. Press it twice, any other key cancels. The last remaining preset cannot be deleted.
1...0, e r t d f g	STATIONS	Set the hovered station as that slot of the active preset. The same key again clears it. A station sits in one slot only, so it moves.
DEL / BACKSPACE	STATIONS	Remove the hovered station from the active preset
/	STATIONS / SELECT PRESET	Back to the search box
SHIFT+←/→	outside the search box	Previous / next preset
ESC	search	Clear the search; if it is already empty, close the menu
ESC	STATIONS / SELECT PRESET	Close the menu

Names have 1 to 24 characters and must be unique (capital letters don't matter). Presets are saved on every change to `presets.txt`.

11.7 RADIO BROWSER menu (SHIFT+s)

Searches the public station directory radio-browser.info and tunes or adds what it finds. Six input panes sit on top, **RESULTS** and **STATION INFO** (every detail of the hovered result) below.

NAME

TAGS (comma separated, all must match)

COUNTRY (name or code, e.g. DE)

STATE / REGION

LANGUAGE (e.g. german)

BITRATE (kbps: e.g. 128 or range via 64-192)

RESULTS (144)

Groove Salad (128k M	US	128k MP3	ambient,chil...
• SomaFM Secret Age...	US	128k MP3	ambient,down...
SomaFM Indie Pop ...	US	128k AAC	indie,indie ...
SomaFM Heavyweigh...	US	320k MP3	reggae,rocks...
• SomaFM Space Stat...	US	128k AAC	ambient,elec...
SomaFM SF Police ...	US	128k MP3	police scanner
• SomaFM Undergroun...	US	128k MP3	80s,new wave...
SomaFM Left Coast...	US	320k MP3	easy listeni...
Soma FM Groove Sa...	US	320k MP4	groove,hls,s...
• SomaFM PopTron (1...	US	128k MP3	electropop,i...
• SomaFM Drone Zone...	US	128k MP3	ambient,atmo...
SomaFM Groove Sal...	US	128k AAC	ambient,chil...
• SomaFM Deep Space...	US	128k MP3	ambient,elec...
SomaFM Lush (128k...	US	128k MP3	electronic,f...
SomaFM Metal Dete...	US	128k AAC	black metal,...
• SomaFM SF 10-33 (...)	US	128k MP3	ambient,expe...

(128 more)

STATION INFO

Name : SomaFM Groove Salad (128k MP3)
Country : The United States Of America (US)
State : California
Language : english
Tags : ambient, chillout, downtempo, groove, lounge, sleep
Bitrate : 128 kbps MP3
Votes : 47655
Clicks : 133 in the last 24 h
Online : yes (checked 2026-09-30 18:23:09 UTC)
Homepage : <https://soma.fm.com/groovesalad/>
Stream : <https://ice6.soma.fm.com/groovesalad-128-mp3>
In list : no ([a] adds it)

[TAB] Next pane | [ENTER] Search / Tune | [↑↓] Navi. | [/] Back to NAME | [ESC] Clear / Close | RESULTS: [a] Add to list

144 stations from del.api.radio-browser.info (most clicked first, offline ones hidden)

Tuned in: Radio Paradise (LIVE 00:00:23) ↗ Angus & Julia Stone - Black Crow

The RADIO BROWSER with a search for "Soma". A dot in front of a result means it is already in your list.

Pane	What you type
NAME	Part of the station name
TAGS	Comma separated, every tag has to match (rock , 80s)
COUNTRY	A name (Germany) or a two-letter code (DE)
STATE / REGION	Part of the region name
LANGUAGE	As Radio Browser spells it (german)
BITRATE	In kbps: 128 = at least 128, 64-192 = range, -192 = at most 192
Key	What it does
TAB	NAME → TAGS → COUNTRY → STATE → LANGUAGE → BITRATE → RESULTS → NAME
ENTER	In a pane: search (focus jumps to RESULTS when the results arrive). In RESULTS: tune the hovered station.
↑ / ↓	In a pane: one pane row up / down (down from the last row: RESULTS). In RESULTS: move the cursor.
a	In RESULTS: add the hovered station to your station list (appended at the end, so presets keep their slots)
/	In RESULTS: back to NAME
ESC	In a pane: clear it. Empty pane or RESULTS: close the menu.
? / CTRL+c	Cheat sheet (RESULTS only) / quit (in a pane CTRL+c copies)

Every search sends "hide broken streams" and sorts by clicks (most clicked first), with at most 200 results. Empty panes are left out. Results whose last check failed are dimmed and hidden by default. The line under

the results shows what is tuned in right now, including the track title if the stream sends one. Tuning a station counts one click at Radio Browser, as their API asks. If `a` finds no `stations.txt` yet, it creates one from the built-in list plus the new station.

11.8 STATION LISTS menu (`SHIFT+p`)

Named, ordered collections of stations (a "jazz" list, a "morning" list ...), built and managed like the player's playlist editor. Use `p` in the search box (see 11.5) to open one on the main screen.

Two tabs, switched with `ALT+←/→` from every pane (`Option` on macOS):

- **CREATE / EDIT.** The top pane holds the list's `Name`: field (25 characters, the field turns red while you type). Below it: SEARCH ALL STATIONS (name, genre, country), then STATIONS (all stations, or the search results) beside LIST CONTENTS (what you are building).
- **SAVED STATION LISTS.** The search field and the saved lists.

STATION LISTS

[CREATE / EDIT]

SAVED STATION LISTS

Name:

SEARCH ALL STATIONS

Search: 30 / 30

STATIONS (sort: list order)

1	Radio Paradise	Eclectic Rock	128k AAC
2	SomaFM Groove Salad	Ambient / Chill	128k MP3
3	SomaFM Indie Pop ...	Indie	128k MP3
4	Deutschlandfunk	Info / Culture	128k MP3
5	TEST Stereo Chords	Test signal	PCM
6	TEST Sine 440 Hz	Test signal	PCM
7	TEST Pink Noise	Test signal	PCM
8	Vaporwave	vaporwave	64k OGG
9	SomaFM Vaporwaves...	vaporwave	128k MP3
10	SomaFM Secret Age...	ambient / dow...	128k MP3
11	SomaFM Space Stat...	ambient / ele...	128k AAC
12	SomaFM Undergroun...	80s / new wav...	128k MP3
13	SomaFM PopTron (1...	electropop / ...	128k MP3
14	SomaFM Drone Zone...	ambient / atm...	128k MP3
15	SomaFM Deep Space...	ambient / ele...	128k MP3
16	SomaFM SF 10-33 (...)	ambient / exp...	128k MP3
17	SomaFM DEF CON Ra...	ambient / chi...	128k AAC
18	Deutschlandfunk K...	culture / new...	128k MP3
19	Deutschlandfunk N...	culture / new...	192k AAC

(11 more)

LIST CONTENTS (0)

empty - ENTER on a station adds it

[Alt+↔] Switch Tab | [TAB] Focus | [↑↓] Navi. | [ENTER] Add/Load | [DEL] Remove | [4/5] Move ↑↓ | [s/HOME] Save | [SHIFT+t] Sort | [SHIFT+↔] Mark | [Ctrl+C/X/V] Copy/Cut/Paste | [/] Search | [?] Cheatsheet | [ESC] Clear / Exit

CREATE / EDIT: name field, search, all stations on the left, the list being built on the right.

STATION LISTS

CREATE / EDIT

[SAVED STATION LISTS]

SEARCH STATION LISTS

Search: 1 / 1

STATION LISTS (1) ◀

1	Meow_Radio	3 stations
---	------------	------------

[Alt+↔] Switch Tab | [TAB] Focus | [↑↓] Navi. | [ENTER] Add/Load | [DEL] Remove | [4/5] Move ↑↓ | [s/HOME] Save | [SHIFT+t] Sort | [SHIFT+↔] Mark | [Ctrl+C/X/V] Copy/Cut/Paste | [/] Search | [?] Cheatsheet | [ESC] Clear / Exit

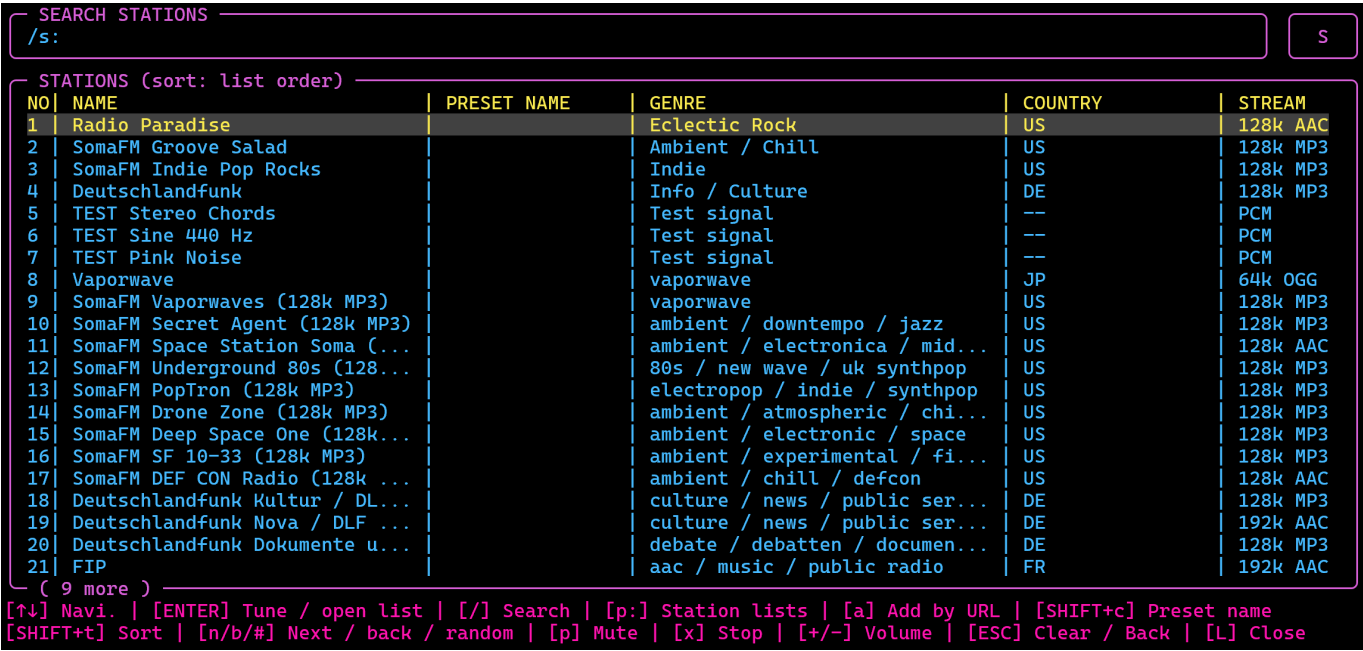
SAVED STATION LISTS.

Key	Where	What it does
ALT+←/→	anywhere	Switch tab
TAB	anywhere	Tab 1: name → search → STATIONS → LIST CONTENTS. Tab 2: search ↔ list.
ENTER	name	On to the search
ENTER	search, STATIONS	Add the hovered station to the end of the list (a station is in a list once)
ENTER	LIST CONTENTS	Tune the hovered station (to audition the list)
SHIFT+t	STATIONS	Sort: list order ↔ name A-Z (also sorts search results)
4 / 5, DEL / BACKSPACE / d	LIST CONTENTS	Move the hovered station up / down, remove it
s or HOME	s : STATIONS / LIST CONTENTS, HOME : every pane of tab 1	Save under the typed name and stay in the menu (the same name overwrites; an empty name: "enter a name first")
ENTER	tab 2 search / list	To the list / load the hovered list into tab 1
DEL	tab 2 list	Delete the hovered list after a Yes/No question
/	STATIONS, LIST CONTENTS, tab 2 list	Back to the search box
ESC	search with text	Clear it
ESC	otherwise	Close. With unsaved changes on tab 1 it asks Save changes to "x" before exiting? [Y]es [N]o [ESC] cancel.

s is a plain letter, so inside the name and search boxes it is typed; **HOME** saves from anywhere. As in the player, opening the menu starts a fresh list; an existing one comes back through tab 2 → **ENTER**. A dot behind a station in STATIONS means it is already in the list being built. Lists are stored in **stationlists.txt**; stations are matched by URL, then by name, and a station that has been removed from **stations.txt** is dropped when the list is read.

11.9 Big STATIONS overlay (**SHIFT+1**)

The STATIONS pane with the whole screen for its rows and an extra **PRESET NAME** column. It shares the search box and the state of the main screen (**/**, **p**:, **s**:, **SHIFT+t**; **ESC** clears the search, leaves a list, then closes). **ENTER** tunes the hovered station and **n b # p x + -** work as on the main screen. Keys that would open another menu are ignored while it is open.



The big STATIONS overlay with the PRESET NAME column.

Key	What it does
a	Add a station by its stream URL. TAB switches URL ↔ NAME, an empty NAME becomes the host name. The station is appended to the end (so the preset slots stay valid) and written to stations.txt. A stream that is already in the list is refused.
SHIFT+c	Give the hovered station a preset name: a shorter second name that is shown in the PRESETS pane instead of the station name (empty = the station's own name again). It is stored in preset_names.txt and the search also looks at it.
SHIFT+l / ESC	Close

11.10 Recording (y)

y starts recording what the tuned station delivers (before volume, mute and the mono fold); the dial's footer shows REC mm:ss. y again stops. While it runs the recording is a WAV file, which ffmpeg then converts in the background to <YYYY-MM-DD_HH-MM-SS>.mp3 (the ID3 title is the current "artist - title", or the station name). The WAV is removed afterwards (it is kept if the conversion fails). Tuning another station or x ends the recording too, and recordings shorter than half a second are discarded. Recordings go to the radio's download folder (see 11.12, PATHS), which by default is the player's one.

11.11 Listening history (h)

The radio keeps its own listening history, shaped like the player's (chapter 8) but with channels instead of tracks. Three tabs (1 2 3, ←/→, TAB), ↑/↓ move, HOME/END jump to the ends, ESC, q or h close. The bottom border shows the line count or the sort direction.

LISTENING HISTORY

HISTORY

TOP CHANNELS

HABITS

10-07 22:30 TEST Stereo Chords (no title) 0:25

10-07 22:29 Radio Paradise Two Feet 1:38

10-07 21:58 Radio Paradise 070 Shake Baby Driver 0:07

10-07 21:44 Radio Paradise Te Vaka Te Namu 0:22

10-07 21:25 SomaFM Groove Salad (no title) 1:48

10-07 21:25 Classic FM Movies Jerome Moross The Big Country - Main Theme 0:04

10-07 21:24 TEST Find on YouTube + download 0:40

10-07 21:24 Radio Search: Quetzal Planta De Los Pies 0:09

10-07 09:27 Radio 8 results 0:09

10-07 09:23 Radio [] QUETZAL -- Planta De Los Pies (akiraboch) 4:31 3:16

10-07 04:07 Radio [] Planta De Los Pies (Quetzal - Topic) 4:33 0:14

10-07 03:40 Radio [] Quetzal - Planta de los Pies (Levitt Pavillion, Pasadena 20... 4:57 0:11

10-07 03:39 Radio [] WHY DO I HAVE YELLOW PLANTS? WHAT HOME REMEDIES TO APPLY... 6:35 0:22

10-07 02:47 Radio [] How to Solve Plantar Fasciitis NO MORE HEEL PAIN! (ATHLEAN... 13:58 0:20

10-07 01:10 Radio [] Why are the SOLES of my FEET YELLOW? (ONsalus) 3:15 2:58

10-07 01:05 Radio [] \ud83e\udd66\ud83c\udffb Como hacer un AUTOMASAJE de PIE pa... 14:56 5:12

10-07 01:04 Radio [] Fascitis plantar, 5 ejercicios para aliviar el dolor y prev... 6:19 1:07

10-07 01:03 Radio to: C:\Users\stsch\Music\MeowerShell-yt-dlp 1:03

10-07 01:03 Radio [ENTER] download [↑↓] select [TAB] edit [ESC] close 0:22

10-07 01:00 Radio Paradise Duke Ellington How High The Moon 2:35

10-07 00:57 Radio Paradise Sofi Tukker Bread (butter version) 2:35

10-07 00:55 Radio Paradise Anders Osborne Dark Decatur Love 2:35

10-07 00:51 Radio Paradise Anders Osborne Dark Decatur Love 3:22

10-07 00:49 Radio Paradise Supertramp Goodbye Stranger 1:24

10-07 00:45 TEST Stereo Chords (no title) 2:29

50 lines (max 10000)

[↔/TAB] Tab | [1/2/3] Tab | [↑↓] Move | [HOME/END] Ends | [y] Find on YouTube + download | [ESC] Exit

HISTORY tab with the "Find on YouTube + download" overlay open.

- **HISTORY.** WHEN / CHANNEL / ARTIST / TITLE / HEARD. A new line starts whenever the channel, artist or title changes; lines heard for less than 3 seconds are dropped. Hover a line and press **y**: a small overlay searches YouTube for "artist title" (the player's own online search). **ENTER** downloads the hovered result (yt-dlp, opus) into the download folder; **[...]** means downloading, **[ok]** done, **[!!]** failed. **TAB** edits the search query, **ESC** closes the overlay.
- **TOP CHANNELS.** Channels by time listened; **r** flips most / least first.
- **HABITS.** Sessions (a gap of 30 minutes starts a new one), time per day, channels, and listening by hour of the day and by weekday.

LISTENING HISTORY

HISTORY

TOP CHANNELS

HABITS

CHANNEL

LINES

LISTENED ▼

Radio Paradise 32 58m

Vaporwave 4 30m

SomaFM Vaporwaves (128k MP3) 2 11m

TEST Stereo Chords 4 11m

SomaFM Secret Agent (128k MP3) 1 11m

SomaFM Groove Salad 1 1m

TEST Sine 440 Hz 3 1m

TEST Pink Noise 2 17s

Classic FM Movies 1 4s

most listened first

[↔/TAB] Tab | [1/2/3] Tab | [↑↓] Move | [r] Flip sort | [ESC] Exit

TOP CHANNELS.



HABITS.

Like the player's, the history is light-weight: the newest 10 000 lines are kept in memory and in `history_radio.txt`; beyond that the oldest line is folded into `archive_radio.txt` (totals per channel, per day, per hour and per weekday), so TOP CHANNELS and HABITS stay lifetime figures.

11.12 Radio settings

`s` opens the radio's settings with the same frame, tab strip and editing keys as the player's (chapter 10): `TAB` next tab, `↑/↓` rows, `←/→` or `ENTER` change a switch, `ENTER` edits a colour, a folder or a key. `s` **saves and closes**, `ESC / q / CTRL+c` **discard** what was changed meanwhile and close. The settings always open on the first tab. They are stored in `radio_config.txt`; colours from the player's `config.txt` are not carried over.

COLORS. Cells hold palette numbers 0 to 255 (empty or 0 = the terminal's own colour). The rows that exist only in the radio:

Row	Cells	What it colours
ON_AIR	UPPER_LEFT, BOTTOM_RIGHT	The ON AIR sign's diagonal gradient (also needle, lamp, LIVE text)
OSCI	LEFT, RIGHT	The oscilloscope
FREQUENCY_BAR	LINE, MHz	The dial's line and ticks / the numbers and the small dots
VOLUME	CURRENT, POSSIBLE	The # and - of the volume bar
PRESETS	INACTIVE FG/BG, KEY FG	Unassigned preset slots / the shortcut letters

BORDER_COLOR, METADATA, VIZ, LIST, HEADER, LEGEND and TAB_NAMES work as in the player.

ON/OFF (the radio's own switches):

Row	What it does
On air ascii	The ON AIR sign and its colour wave
Pulse wave	The faint circle burst behind the sign
Dummy buttons	The <<< MUTE >>> boxes next to the dial (the volume bar stays)
Osci/sphere	Right of the station info: oscilloscope, sphere, or off
Visualizer	The spectrum under the station info
Stereo sound	Off folds left and right into mono (the dial's footer then says MONO)
Normalize volume	Loudness normalization, as v
Osci style	braille or image
Tuning noise	Off by default. On: static with crackle fades in while another station is tuned and stays until the new stream plays. It follows volume, mute and the sleep-timer fade and is not recorded.

ANIMATION. Vis. Fluidity, Vis. Degradation and Vis. Viscosity as in the player, **Playback mode** (list / shuffle for the station surf, same as m), plus two radio-only speeds: **Gradient wave speed** (cycles per second of the ON AIR sign's colour wave) and **Pulse wave speed** (loops per second of the circle burst). The player's Waveform Style, Lyrics Alignment and Lyrics Animation do not exist in the radio.

PATHS. The radio's files live below these folders. The layout is the player's: the name of the setting in the header colour, its value in the list colour. Every path is a *base*; the radio creates its own sub-folders below it.

Row	Result
STATION LISTS PATH	<path>/stations/stations.txt (the overall list) and <path>/station_lists/stationlists.txt
PRESETS PATH	<path>/presets/presets.txt
DOWNLOAD PATH	<path>/radio_downloads/: recordings (y) and YouTube downloads from the history. Below the path: <i>SAME PATH AS THE MUSIC PLAYER IS USED</i> while the next row is on.
Same folder as music player	On = use the player's download folder instead of DOWNLOAD PATH
HISTORY PATH	<path>/radio_history/ (history_radio.txt, archive_radio.txt)

An empty path shows the default folder in effect. When folder paths are changed, the respective files are **only copied, never moved, and no deletions are performed**; playback is stopped and everything is reloaded from the new place.

REFERENCE. The keys that are not hard coded, grouped like the player's. **ENTER** edits the hovered key: type one character (case matters) or **SPACE** / **TAB** / **BACKSPACE**; **DEL** restores the default. A key already in use is refused (the fixed keys count too: the preset slot keys and j / k). The first line, *Reset all keys to default*, sits

under the cheat-sheet note; **CTRL+SHIFT+u** undoes the last five key changes. Keys are stored as **HKey<Action>=** lines. The cheat sheet always lists the default keys.

ABOUT APP. The same text as the player's.

11.13 The radio's files

File	What it holds	Default place
<code>radio_config.txt</code>	The radio's settings, colours, equalizer and oscilloscope values	The config folder (<code>~/.config/mousiki/</code> , on Windows <code>%USERPROFILE%\config\mousiki\</code>)
<code>stations.txt</code>	Your station list	Config folder, or next to the executable
<code>presets.txt</code>	The presets and the active one	Config folder
<code>stationlists.txt</code>	The saved station lists	Config folder
<code>preset_names.txt</code>	The preset names (<code>url<TAB>name</code>)	Next to <code>stations.txt</code>
<code>radio_history/</code>	<code>history_radio.txt</code> and <code>archive_radio.txt</code>	Config folder
Recordings and downloads	MP3 recordings, YouTube downloads	The player's download folder, otherwise <code><path>/radio_downloads/</code>

`stations.txt` has one station per line: `name | genre | country | codec | kbps | url | [*] | [dial MHz]`. A `*` fills the first preset slots of the preset "Default" until a `presets.txt` exists. The URL `lavfi:chords`, `lavfi:tone` or `lavfi:noise` is an offline test signal generated by ffmpeg.

`presets.txt` is plain text and can be edited by hand:

```
@keys 1234567890ertdfg
@active Morning
[Default]
1 | https://stream.radioparadise.com/aac-128 | Radio Paradise
[Morning]
1 | https://st01.sslstream.dlf.de/dlf/01/128/mp3/stream.mp3 | Deutschlandfunk
```

The `@keys` line names the letters of the slots the file was written with (slot 1 = first letter ... slot 16 = last), so presets keep their slots if the key letters ever change.

11.14 Not done yet

- Station lists steer `n` / `b` / `#`, but not yet the presets: the presets always refer to the overall station list.
- The PRESETS menu has no page-jump keys (arrows only).
- The radio is untested on macOS and Windows beyond what is described here.

About this app

Original developer of v1.0

Developer	ender	GitHub	itzender5820
Email	itz.ender5820@gmail.com	Version	original and final v1.0
		Licence	Apache Licence 2.0

Windows port, incl. extensive modifications up to v3.0.0 (including the radio mode)

Developer	Steffen Schwerdtfeger	GitHub	StSchwerdtfeger
Email	fanti.blub@gmail.com	Version	current v3.0.0
		Licence	Apache Licence 2.0